

Digital Marketing & Transformation (BCAE0005)



MODULE-I

- **Introduction to Digital Marketing**
 - Modern Marketing- How Marketing Works,
 - Fundamentals Channels- Awareness,
 - Consideration & Decision Making,
 - Building Integrated Marketing Plan,
 - Lead Journey- From Prospect to Sales.

- **Website and Blogging**

- The Power Of Storytelling, Know Your Customer - Market And Content Research,
- Construct Prospective Buyer Personas & Journeys,
- Establishing The Content Ideation & Creation Framework,
- Creative Design Principles,
- Linking Blogs To Social Network (Conversation Blogs),
- Measuring And Optimizing Blog Performance,
- Importance Of Responsive Design,
- Leverage Landing Pages And Forms To Accelerate Conversion.

- **Content Promotion**

- SEO as an Art and as a Science,
- Ranking Algorithms,
- Website Audit,
- Optimizing Digital Assets & Metadata,
- Decoding Common Paid Media Platforms,
- Influencer Marketing,
- Black Hat, White Hat and Grey Hat SEO

PART-I

INTRODUCTION TO DIGITAL MARKETING

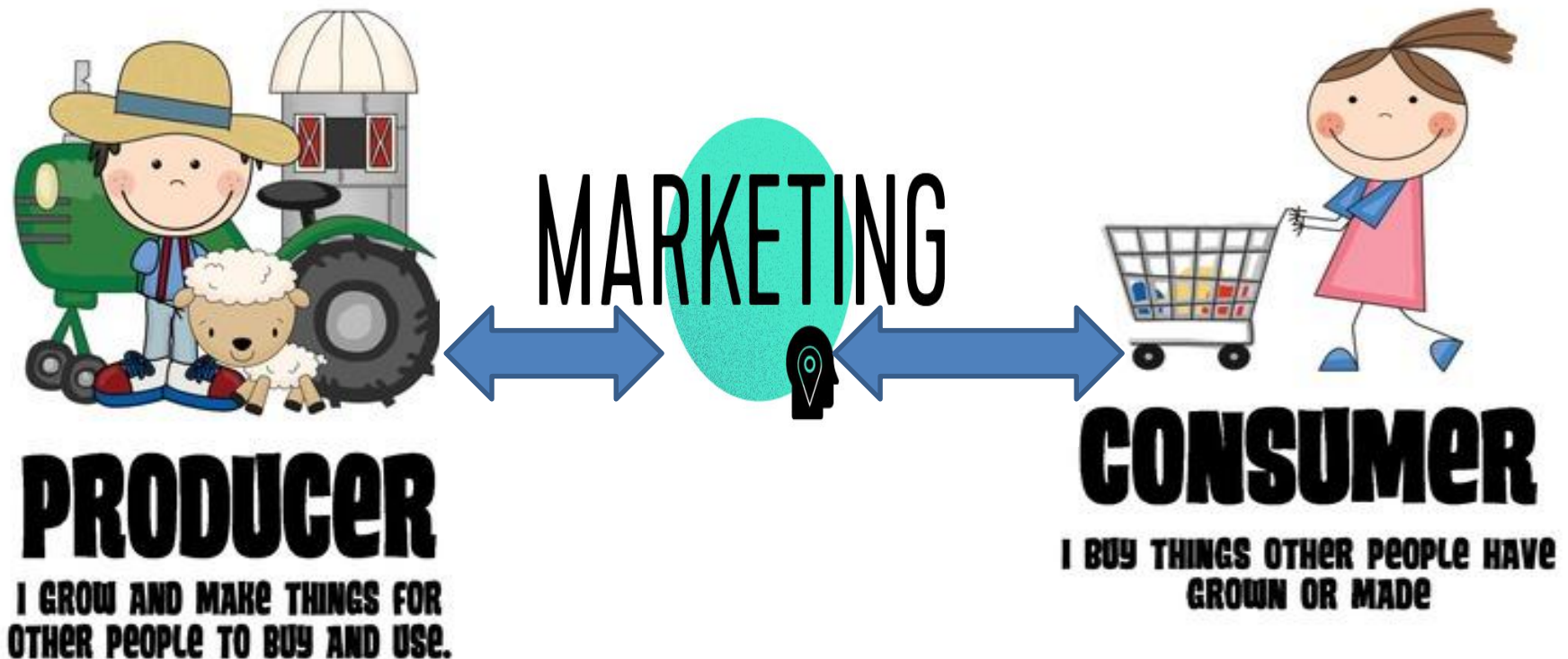
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Lecture -1

Digital Marketing Introduction

- Marketing: a gateway of influence between producers and consumers



Digital Vs Traditional Marketing

DIGITAL MARKETING

VS

TRADITIONAL MARKETING



Digital marketing

- The promotion of products or brands via one or more forms of electronic media
- and
- It provides different methods to analyze the marketing campaigns and understand on what is working and what isn't – typically in real time.

“Marketing of products and services using digital technologies”

- **Digital marketers** are the ones who monitor the wireless based channels and **decipher** insights like what is being viewed, how often and for how long it is being viewed, sales conversions, what content works and doesn't work, etc.

- "decipher" means to **interpret and understand complex data, trends, and user behavior to gain actionable insights.**
- how "decipher" applies to digital marketing:
- Analyzing Data> Understanding User Behavior> Decoding Algorithms>Interpreting Market Trends> Making Informed Decisions

Examples of deciphering in digital marketing:

- Analyzing website analytics to identify which pages are performing well and which need improvement.
- Using social media listening tools to understand what people are saying about a brand or product.
- Conducting A/B testing to determine which version of an ad or landing page performs better.
- Analyzing customer data to identify customer segments and personalize marketing messages.

Digital marketing channels

- Internet is the channel most closely associated with digital marketing however they would also include wireless channels like text messaging, mobile instant messaging, mobile apps, podcasts, digital television and radio channels, etc.

Goal of digital marketing

- Utilize the medium of digital devices to connect identified targeted segments of users with relevant business offerings.
- Marketers design various strategies to target and reach out to prospects to grab their attention and eventually convert them to loyal customers.

Why digital marketing

- 71% of companies plan to increase their digital marketing budgets year on year (Source: Webbiquity)
- On average, 60% of a marketer's time is devoted to digital marketing activities, fueling demand for digital marketing skills (Source: Smart Insights and Ecommerce Expo)
- One-third of businesses have embraced a Digital Transformation program while the other one third have put forward proposals to implement a similar strategy (Source: Smart Insights and TFM&A)
- Digital content creation and management now claim the second-largest share of digital marketing budgets (Source: KaPost)
- 28% of marketers have reduced their traditional advertising budget to fund more digital marketing (Source: CMO Council)
- 73% of B2B marketers use video as a content marketing tactic, and 7% of marketers plan on increasing their YouTube marketing initiatives (Source: Content Marketing Institute)

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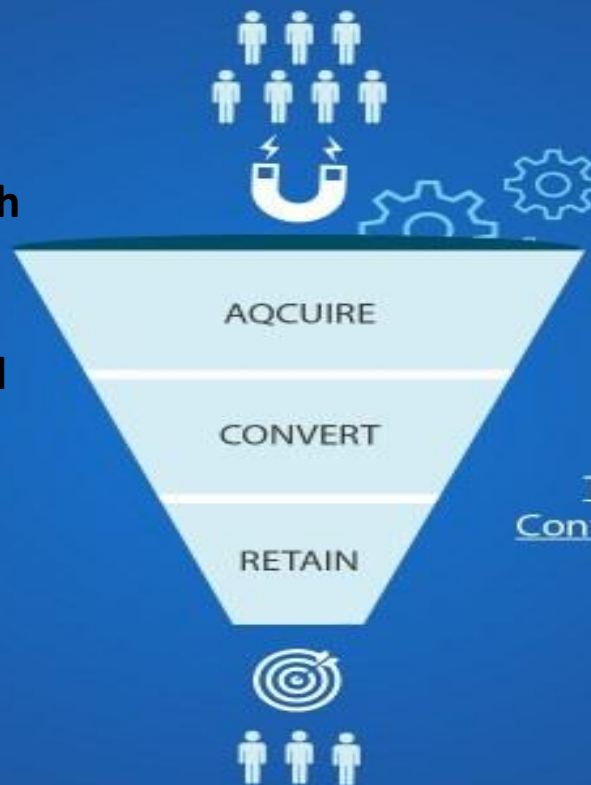


Lecture -2

The Digital Conversion Funnel

acquisition to conversion to retention

The process begins with prospect targeting, followed by funneling the acquired lead towards conversion.



Leads are acquired, converted to customers, and then retained for additional transactions.

The Digital Conversion Funnel

Check your knowledge

- Doing business online brings lots of fantastic opportunities – it can really help your company in new and exciting ways.
- Once your business is online, what opportunities can you take advantage of?

Select the 5 **right** answers

- A. Finding lots of new customers – everyone's online these days
- B. Selling your products or services straight from your website or app
- C. Delivering targeted advertising to customers
- D. Saving money on your heating bills
- E. Learning more about what your customers love
- F. Using analytics to power your online sales

Answers:

- A. Finding lots of new customers – everyone's online these days
- B. Selling your products or services straight from your website or app
- C. Delivering targeted advertising to customers
- E. Learning more about what your customers love
- F. Using analytics to power your online sales

1.1.1 Modern Marketing - How It Works

- What are the things which the customer wants?
- How these things can be made available to them?

6 Concepts of modern marketing

- Concept of Production
- Concept of Product
- Concept of Selling
- Concept of Marketing
- Concept of Customer
- Concept of Societal marketing

a) Concept of Production

- Primary focus
 - manufacturing or production.
- Presume that
 - The customer will buy the product which comes out in the market and
 - will respond accordingly to available products only.
- **Note that this concept is rarely applied in the modern marketing world as it boosts sales in the initial stages, but in the longer run it tends to become unfriendly and is unaware of customer interests.**

b) Concept of Product

- Primary focus
 - features and the quality of the product,
- Presume that
 - the product can only survive in the competitive world by maintaining the quality standards.
- This concept suggests that customers will respond to products of the best quality at the most reasonable price.

c) Concept of Selling

- Primary focus
 - On sales
- Presume that
 - The increase in sales volume would eventually increase their profits.

d) Concept of Marketing

- **Primary focus**
 - product promotion,
- **Presume that**
 - consumers should know about the product before they make a buying decision.
- This also helps in creating a perception of transparency which in-turn builds trust.

e) Concept of Customer

- **Primary focus**
 - one to one marketing,
 - and this is always applied in conjunction with the concept of marketing.
- **Presume that**
 - One to one interaction with customer to attain progressive levels of trust.

f) Concept of Societal marketing

- Companies implementing this concept are not only focused on product sales or profits but also believe in giving back something to society for human welfare.

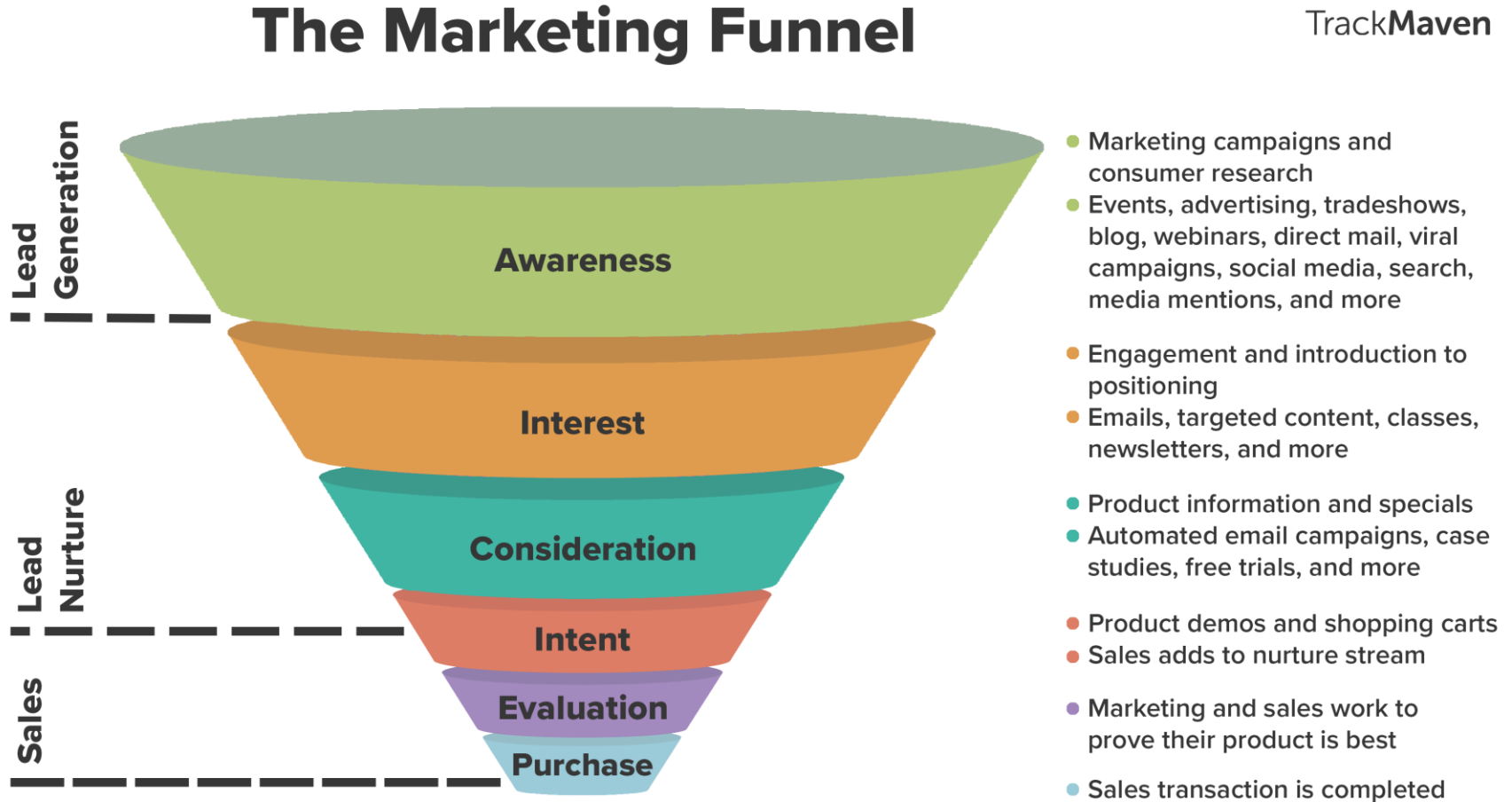


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Lecture -3

1.1.2 Fundamentals channels- Awareness, Consideration & Decision Making



Awareness:

- Potential customers are drawn into this stage through marketing campaigns and consumer research and discovery.
- Trust and thought leadership is established with events, advertising, trade shows, content (blog posts, etc.), webinars, direct mail, viral campaigns, social media, search, media mentions, and more.
- Here, lead generation takes place, as information is collected and leads are pulled into a lead management system for nurturing further down the funnel.

Interest

- Once leads are generated, they move on to the interest stage,
- Learn more about the company, its products, and any helpful information and research it provides.
- Here is an opportunity for brands to develop a relationship with the people in its lead database and introduce its positioning.
- Marketers can nurture leads through emails, content that is more targeted around industries and brands, classes, newsletters, and more.

Consideration

- In the consideration stage, leads have been changed into marketing qualified leads and are seen as prospective customers.
- Marketers can send prospects, more information about products and offers through automated email campaigns, while continuing to nurture them with targeted content, case studies, free trials, and more.

Intent

- To get to the intent stage, prospects must demonstrate that they are interested in buying a brand's product.
- This can happen in a survey, after a product demo, or when a product is placed in the shopping cart on an ecommerce website.
- This is an opportunity for marketers to make a strong case for why their product is the best choice for a buyer.

Evaluation

- In the evaluation stage, buyers are making a final decision about whether or not to buy a brand's product or services.
- Typically, marketing and sales work together closely to nurture the decision-making process and convince the buyer that their brand's product is the best choice.

Purchase

- This is the last stage in the marketing funnel, where a prospect has made the decision to buy and turns into a customer.
- This is where sales takes care of the purchase transaction.
- A positive experience on the part of the buyer can lead to referrals that fuel the top of the marketing funnel, and the process begins again.

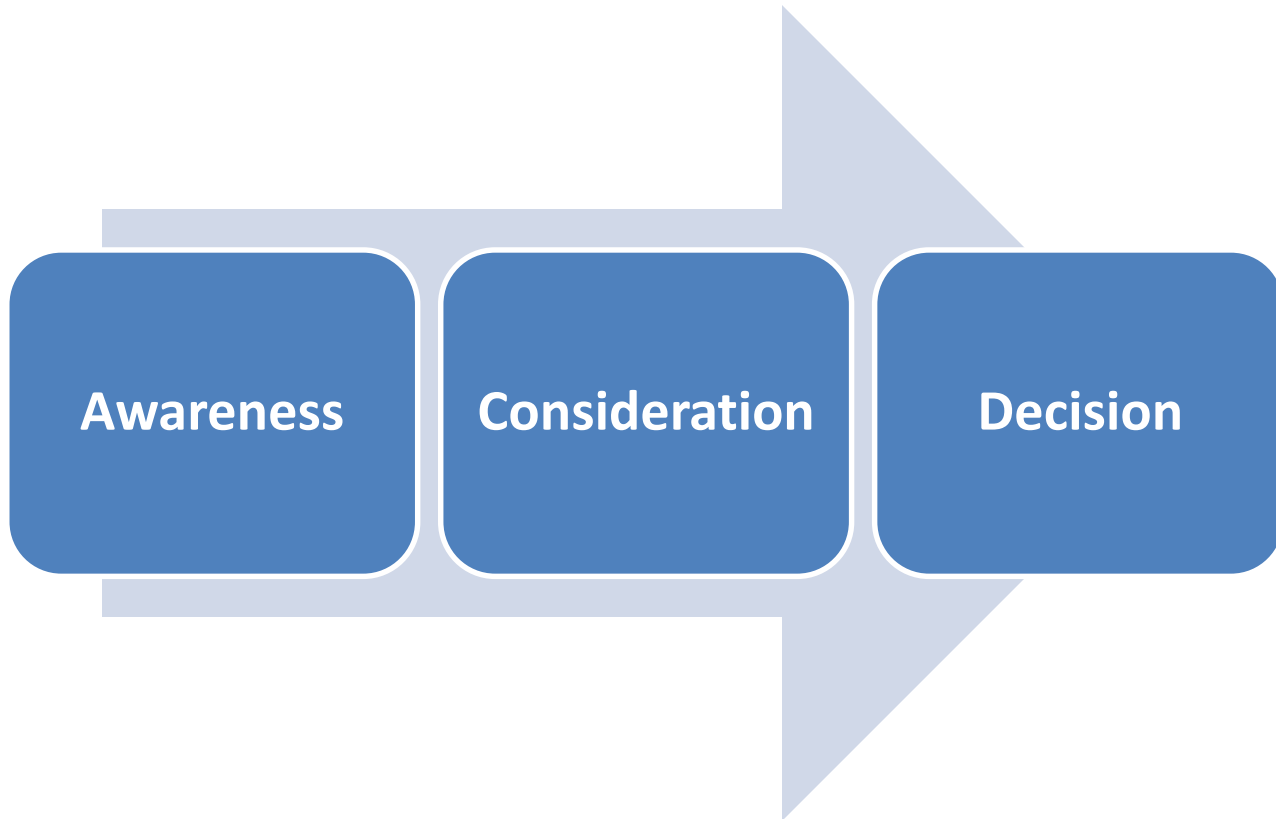
- This model or fundamental channels are purely based on the **interest of the audience**.
- Being a marketer, it is necessary to know **the type of audience and their specific interest** to gain efficiency in your marketing strategies.
- **Content mapping strategy** plays a key role in understanding the audience and deriving their topic of interest.

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Lecture -4

Buyer's Journey





User Behaviour/
Research Needs

Behaviour and research needs differ in each stage of The Buyer's Journey

Awareness Stage

Prospects is experiencing and expressing symptoms of a problem or opportunity.

Consideration Stage

Prospects has now clearly defined and given a name to their problem or opportunity.

Decision Stage

Prospects has now decided on their solutions strategy, method, or approach.

Awareness Stage:

- What's happening:** The potential customer realizes they have a problem or an opportunity. They're experiencing symptoms or feeling a need, but they haven't clearly defined what it is yet.
- Example:** Someone's computer is running very slowly. They know it's a problem, but they don't know if it's a virus, a full hard drive, or something else.
- Their behavior:** They're likely searching for general information about their symptoms. They might search for "why is my computer so slow?"

Consideration Stage:

- What's happening:** The potential customer has now clearly defined their problem or opportunity. They're researching different solutions to address it.
- Example:** The person with the slow computer has now determined it's likely due to a lack of RAM. They're now researching different RAM upgrades and comparing brands.
- Their behavior:** They're actively comparing different options and looking for information about the features, benefits, and drawbacks of each. They might search for "best RAM for gaming" or "how to install RAM."

Decision Stage:

- What's happening:** The potential customer has decided on a solution strategy and is now choosing a specific product or service.
- Example:** The person has chosen a specific brand and model of RAM and is now deciding where to buy it from (online store, local shop, etc.).
- Their behavior:** They're focused on making a final decision and might be looking for reviews, price comparisons, or information about warranties and shipping. They might search for "where to buy [specific RAM model]" or "reviews of [specific online store]."



Content Type/
Format

Specific Content Types are most relevant at specific stages of The Buyer's Journey

Awareness Stage



Analysts Reports
Research reports
eGuides & eBooks
Editorial Content
Whitepapers
Educational Content

Prospects is experiencing and expressing symptoms of a problem or opportunity.

Consideration Stage



Comparison White papers
Expert Guides
Live Interactions
Webcasts/Podcasts/
Video

Prospects has now clearly defined and given a name to their problem or opportunity.

Decision Stage



Vendor Comparisons
Product Comparisons
Case Studies
Trial Download
Product Literature
Live Demo

Prospects has now decided on their solutions strategy, method, or approach.

- **The Buyer's Journey Stages:**
- **Awareness Stage:** The buyer realizes they have a need or problem.
- **Consideration Stage:** The buyer defines their needs and researches potential solutions.
- **Decision Stage:** The buyer chooses a specific solution and vendor.
- **Real-Life Example: Buying a New Car**
- **1. Awareness Stage:**
- **Problem/Opportunity:** John's old car is constantly breaking down, costing him money and causing him inconvenience. He realizes he needs a more reliable vehicle.

- **Consideration Stage:**
- **Defined Need:** John has decided he wants a fuel-efficient SUV with good safety ratings and enough space for his family.
- **Content Types:** Now, John is comparing specific options and features.
 - **Comparison White Papers:** He might download a comparison chart of different SUV models, comparing fuel economy, cargo space, and safety features.
 - **Expert Guides:** He might read reviews from automotive experts on different SUV brands and models.
 - **Live Interactions/Webcasts/Podcasts/Video:** John might watch YouTube reviews of SUVs or listen to a podcast discussing the latest SUV models.

- **Decision Stage:**
- **Chosen Solution:** John has narrowed his choices to two specific SUV models from different manufacturers.
- **Content Types:** John is now focused on making a final decision and choosing a vendor (dealership).
 - **Vendor Comparisons/Product Comparisons:** He might visit the websites of different dealerships to compare prices, financing options, and warranty packages. He'll also look at detailed spec sheets of the two SUVs.
 - **Case Studies:** He might read customer testimonials or online reviews about the reliability and customer service of different dealerships.
 - **Trial Download/Product Literature/Live Demo:** John schedules test drives at both dealerships to experience the cars firsthand. He also picks up brochures and pricing information.

Keyword &
Relevant terms



Leverage relevant terms in each stage of The Buyer's Journey

Awareness Stage	Consideration Stage	Decision Stage
Issue/Opportunity type terms	Solution type terms	Comparison/ Review type terms
Troubleshoot Issue Resolve Risks Upgrade Improve Optimize Prevent	Solution Provider Service Supplier Tool Device Software Appliance	Compare Versus vs. comparison Pros and Cons Benchmarks Review Test

The Buyer's Journey and Relevant Keywords:

• **Awareness Stage:** The buyer is experiencing a problem or opportunity but hasn't defined a specific solution. They're doing general research.

- **Keyword Focus:** Problem-oriented keywords. These focus on the pain points or challenges the buyer is facing.
- **Example Keywords:**
 - Troubleshoot
 - Issue
 - Resolve
 - Risks
 - Upgrade (implying a need for improvement)
 - Improve
 - Optimize
 - Prevent
- **Real-Life Example (Car Buying):** Instead of searching for "Honda CRV," someone in the awareness stage might search for "car constantly breaking down" or "best way to save money on gas."

Consideration Stage: The buyer has defined their problem and is actively researching potential solutions.

•**Keyword Focus:** Solution-oriented keywords. These focus on the types of products or services that can address the buyer's needs.

•**Example Keywords:**

- Solution
- Provider
- Service
- Supplier
- Tool
- Device
- Software
- Appliance

•**Real-Life Example (Car Buying):** Now that the buyer knows they want a fuel-efficient SUV, they might search for "best fuel-efficient SUVs" or "hybrid SUV reviews."

Decision Stage: The buyer has chosen a solution and is deciding between specific vendors or products.

•**Keyword Focus:** Comparison and review keywords. These focus on comparing specific options and finding the best fit.

•**Example Keywords:**

- Compare
- Versus (vs.)
- Comparison
- Pros and Cons
- Benchmarks
- Review
- Test

•**Real-Life Example (Car Buying):** The buyer has narrowed it down to a Honda CRV and a Toyota RAV4. They might search for "Honda CRV vs Toyota RAV4," "Honda CRV reviews," or "best Honda dealerships near me."

Why This Matters for Marketing:

By understanding the types of keywords people use at each stage, marketers can:

•**Create more targeted content:** Content can be tailored to address the specific needs and questions of buyers at each stage.

•**Improve SEO:** Using the right keywords helps content rank higher in search engine results pages (SERPs) for relevant searches.

•**Run more effective advertising campaigns:** Paid advertising campaigns can be targeted to specific keywords, ensuring that ads are shown to the right audience at the right time.

1.1.3. Building Integrated Marketing Plan

- It is about bringing all the **marketing and branding** techniques together
- Its aim is to develop a tight, seamless, and professional nature for a company.
- This technique can give even small businesses the chance to jet-power their branding and marketing strategies.

1.1.3. Building Integrated Marketing Plan

- **Marketing** is the process of promoting and selling products or services. It encompasses all the activities a company undertakes to reach its target audience, communicate its value proposition, and ultimately drive sales. Marketing tactics include market research, advertising, public relations, social media marketing, content marketing, and more.
- **Branding** is the process of creating a unique identity and image for a product, service, or company in the minds of consumers. It's about shaping perceptions, building emotional connections, and establishing a strong brand reputation. Branding elements include brand name, logo, slogan, visual identity, brand voice, and brand values.
- **In essence:**
 - **Marketing** is what you *do* to promote your business.
 - **Branding** is *who you are* as a business.

1.1.3. Building Integrated Marketing Plan

- **Combining Marketing and Branding Techniques**
- Marketing and branding are not mutually exclusive; they are two sides of the same coin. Effective marketing reinforces branding, and strong branding makes marketing more effective. Here's how to combine them:
 1. **Align Marketing Messages with Brand Values:** Ensure that all your marketing communications reflect your brand's core values, mission, and personality. For example, if your brand emphasizes sustainability, your marketing campaigns should highlight your eco-friendly practices.
 2. **Use Consistent Brand Elements:** Maintain consistency in your brand's visual identity (logo, colors, fonts), messaging, and tone of voice across all marketing channels. This helps reinforce brand recognition and create a cohesive brand experience.

1.1.3. Building Integrated Marketing Plan

- **Build Brand Awareness through Marketing:** Use marketing tactics like content marketing, social media marketing, and public relations to tell your brand story, engage your target audience, and build brand awareness.
- **Create Emotional Connections:** Appeal to your target audience's emotions through storytelling, relatable content, and personalized experiences. This helps build stronger brand loyalty and advocacy.
- **Deliver on Brand Promises:** Ensure that your products or services consistently deliver on the promises you make in your marketing and branding efforts. This builds trust and reinforces a positive brand reputation.

1.1.3. Building Integrated Marketing Plan

- **Examples of Combined Techniques:**
- **Nike:** Nike's "Just Do It" campaign is a classic example of combining marketing and branding. The slogan embodies the brand's values of athleticism, determination, and achievement, while the marketing campaigns feature inspiring stories of athletes overcoming challenges.
- **Apple:** Apple's branding emphasizes innovation, simplicity, and design. Their marketing campaigns consistently showcase these values through sleek product designs, user-friendly interfaces, and compelling advertising.

- A great example of an integrated marketing campaign is Coke's '**share a coke with**' campaign, which used unified messaging across TV, Social, Outdoor and Display leading to a 7% uplift in Coke consumption by the target demographic, making it one of the most successful Coke campaigns in history.



Benefits of integrated marketing communications

Efficiency

- It helps to streamline the processes.
- Once decided on the tactic, it needs to be implemented across each channel.
- It results in a simplified campaign.
- We can use the same messaging and imagery across the campaign,
- We can reduce everything from resource usage, to meeting, and planning time.

Effectiveness

- Connecting the campaigns with the help of an integrated marketing agency can help to make a given strategy more effective.
- It provides a consistent communication through a range of channels,
- It highlight the planned message to a wider audience.
- Uniformity in the image **increases trust and awareness.**

Economical

- Graphics, photography and content can be expensive for any business.
- It save money on creating campaigns,
- It also cuts down on budget wasting that might occur due to disjointed and confusing campaigns.
- This means we get a better return on the investments.

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Lecture -5

1.1.4. Lead Journey- From Prospect to Sales

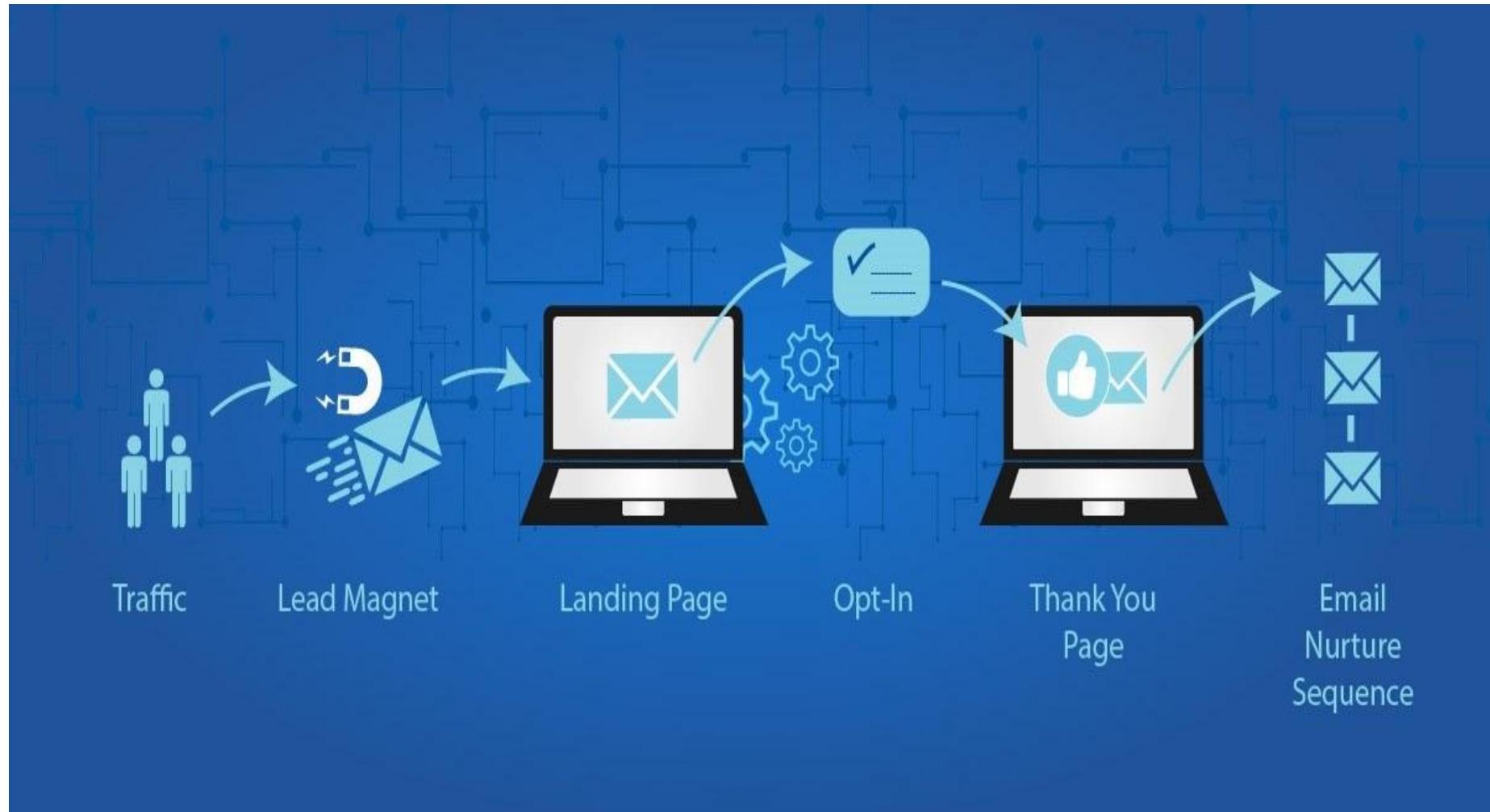
- **Demand Generation:** is creating demand or curiosity for your product.
- For example, when content is used to spread the brand awareness, so as a customer thinks of our brand when choosing a product and/or service.

- **Lead Generation** is the process of collecting relatively specific information about potential customers,
- We can turn them into sales leads.
- These leads will receive content from us which will help build trust and further turn into sales.

NOTE: leads aren't customers, they are potential customers.

- Demand and Lead generation is done through three media types:
 1. **Paid media** – Traditional advertising
 2. **Owned media** – Website, social and email marketing, branding.
 3. **Earned media** (or free **media**) refers to publicity gained through promotional efforts.(word of mouth, referrals, reviews).

Lead generation funnel



- **Lead magnet** (also known as opt-in bribe) is an incentive you offer to potential buyers in exchange for their contact information such as name, email, phone number, etc.
- **Landing page**, sometimes known as a "**lead capture page**", "**static page**" or a "**destination page**", is a single web page that appears in response to clicking on a search engine optimized search result or an online advertisement.
- The landing page will usually display directed sales copy that is a logical extension of the advertisement, search result or link.

- **Opt-in email** is a term used when someone is given the option to receive email.
- Typically, this is some sort of mailing list, newsletter, or advertising.
- Without obtaining permission before sending email, the email is unsolicited bulk email, better known as spam.

Email	Opens	Clicks	Replies	Unsubscribes	Status	Delay Between Emails (?)	
☰ Here's your download [5 Mistakes That Kill eCommerce Growth]	75.0%	75.0%	0.0%	0.0%	Published ▾	Immediately	Remove
☰ Do you know the #1 thing that is killing eCommerce business growth?	71.0%	76.0%	0.0%	0.0%	Published ▾	1 days ▾ ⚙	Remove
☰ Are you making these mistakes...?	66.0%	0.0%	16.7%	0.0%	Published ▾	1 days ▾ ⚙	Remove
☰ What I learned from a Dolphin	66.7%	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	Published ▾	1 days ▾ ⚙	Remove
☰ Do you need help growing your eCommerce business?	66.0%	26.0%	0.0%	0.0%	Published ▾	1 days ▾ ⚙	Remove
☰ Frankly, I don't understand?	66.0%	20.0%	0.0%	20.0%	Published ▾	2 days ▾ ⚙	Remove
☰ Are you still interested in growing your eCommerce business?	66.0%	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	Published ▾	3 days ▾ ⚙	Remove

Summary of what we need to do to build out your lead generation funnel.

- Map out the **customer journey** in the business.
- Map out the **points of contact** we have with our customers.
- Create **one or more lead magnets** to attract visitors to submit their email address.
- Create **landing pages, opt-in forms and thank you pages**.
- Link to an ESP to capture email address and deliver lead magnet and lead nurture email sequence.

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Lecture -6

1.2.1. The Power of Storytelling

“Story telling is a way to connect with anyone irrespective of the culture or the region. State-of-the-art technology will change, but state-of-the-heart storytelling will always be the same”.

- Human beings are emotional creatures and stories are impossible to be resisted by anyone provided if you hear a good one.

- ***“The better the story, the more successful the product and business”.***
- The story should be a representation of ‘what’ and ‘why’ of an organization.
 - What are you doing?
 - Why are you doing it?
- In the terms of Digital Marketing, “If the content is King then the Queen is the visual elements.”

Story-telling tips

- Having the information written textually on a website is simply not enough, so it is essential to publish it in a way that people can enjoy and understand it.
- Visuals are highly important for a website.
- One can use pictures to tell stories all the time.
- Images and videos hold more power over the audience than words.
- Well-told visual stories can really move, mold, or melt the reader's, heart.
- Convincing visual stories will develop strong engagement by evoking emotions, instilling connections with the viewer.

THE SCIENCE OF STORYTELLING

2017

**Humans are wired to connect with compelling stories.
But our brains process stories and content in different ways.**

As businesses invest more in branded content, the most successful content marketing teams need to start by understanding how people consume information and use data to optimize their content strategies.



100,500

digital words are consumed
by the average US citizen
every day



92%

of consumers want
brands to make ads that
feel like a story



60X FASTER

the rate at which the
brain processes images
in comparison to words

HOW STORYTELLING AFFECTS THE BRAIN²

NEURAL COUPLING

A story activates parts in the brain that allows the listener to turn the story in to their own ideas and experience thanks to a process called neural coupling.

MIRRORING

Listeners will not only experience the similar brain activity to each other, but also to the speaker.



DOPAMINE

The brain releases dopamine into the system when it experiences an emotionally-charged event, making it easier to remember and with greater accuracy.

CORTEX ACTIVITY

When processing facts, two areas of the brain are activated (Broca's and Wernicke's area). A well-told story can engage many additional areas, including the motor cortex, sensory cortex and frontal cortex.



Messages delivered as stories can be up to **22X**
more memorable than just facts³

WHAT TYPE OF CONTENT SHOULD YOU USE TO TELL YOUR STORY?



THE WRITTEN WORD



Keep your content skimmable.
Use subheads, bullets and short paragraphs to break up text.

Blog posts with embedded video get linked
3X more than text-only posts.¹

79%

of readers scan written content
rather than reading word by word.

90%

of surveyed professionals admit
to having thrown away important
information without reading it.

Incorporate graphics and
videos to add visual appeal.

Use a strong title and a compelling
hook to engage readers immediately
and create a sense of urgency.



VISUAL CONTENT

Infographics
SlideShares
Social Media Images

50% of our brains are wired to receive visual input.⁴

Infographics are "liked" & shared on social media

3X

more than any other type of content.

People following directions with text & illustrations do

323%

better than people following directions without illustrations.

Use visuals to illustrate complex concepts or data.

Incorporate memorable graphics and images into long-form content to encourage sharing.

Use compelling images via social channels to capture interest and attention.



VIDEO CONTENT

Webinars

Video Testimonials

Tutorials/How-to Videos

"Day in the Life" Videos

Interviews with Experts

Using the word "video" in an email subject line boosts open rates by **19%** and clickthrough rates by **65%**.⁴

By 2017, video content will represent

74%
of all internet traffic.

4X

as many consumers would prefer to watch a video about a product rather than reading about it.

43%

of consumers wanted to see more video content in 2016.

Use video to create an emotional connection with your audience.

Incorporate video across platforms (email, blog, social and more) to drive cross-channel engagement.

Video is one of the best ways to "show" consumers how to engage with your brand, product or service.

WHAT KIND OF STORIES STICK?⁶



68%

of consumers find content that "informs" and "educates" to be the most valuable.

17%

say content that "entertains" is the most valuable.

11%

say content that "inspires" is the most valuable.

WHOLE FOODS MARKET WHOLE STORY

- Serves up individually-targeted recipe recommendations
- 34M carefully targeted impressions
- 40%+ repeat engagement rate

L'ORÉAL MAKEUP.COM

Beauty trend reporting, tutorials, DIYs and influencer content

QUALITY AND RELEVANCE ARE KING

81%

of consumers agree content "quality" is important.

78%

of consumers say that "relevance" is somewhat or very important.





THE FORMULA FOR SMARTER STORYTELLING^{6,7,8}

QUALITY CONTENT

Quality is a balance between working with what you have and partnering with the right collaborators.

42% of B2C marketers start with existing assets/talent, using outsourced help for specialized skills like writing and design.



RELEVANCE

45% of consumers won't spend time with branded content if it's not relevant to their interests.

74% of consumers now get frustrated when brands serve them messages that are irrelevant.



PERSONALIZATION

Consumers expect brands to provide truly personalized experiences—and content's role in how brands deliver on that experience is growing in importance.



ANALYTICS

41% of B2C marketers cited the inability to measure effectiveness as a significant challenge. Partner with your analytics team to ensure you have the tools in place to track content marketing ROI.



BETTER RESULTS

Quality and relevance are the goals of the online content consumer. Personalization is the only way to achieve this goal and gain the attention of your potential customers.

Creating Emotional Connections

- **Communicate with Visuals:** Storytelling on a website isn't really a marketing tactic, instead, it is their history which they share with the world.
- Display and video are the two-primary purpose for the fastest growing digital marketing.
- So, the way a brand is seen, will be the most critical to the decision process and buying cycle.
- **Bringing a Story to Life:** "Animate the Content" - The stories and the art of storytelling plays a major role in bringing lively stories to the end user.
- Creating an appealing content would help in achieving the business goals.
- The audience would prefer to purchase a product/service being offered if the story is associated with the content of website.

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Lecture -7

1.2.2. Know Your Customer - Market & Content Research

- Below are a few traits which companies should gather about their customers:
 - Personality behavior
 - Interests
 - Values
 - Opinions

- Knowing all of this will help the companies to:
 - Come up with an accurate list of topics and keywords to target.
 - Set up pages to convert more effectively.
 - Create a great user experience.
 - Optimize the content.
 - Craft the perfect message to cause readers to take action.
 - Find key influencers in the market.

Step-by-step approach you can use to get to know your audience

Conduct Market Research

- Market research boosts the effectiveness of an organization's web strategy and its application in-market.
- The primary goal in any market research is to record as many details as possible of the target customers, which can later be used to build individual and group personas.

- Below are a few ways through which this information could be gathered:

1. Reach Out to Other Departments:

- For example, sales team would have a better idea of what the prospects need, what are their interest and desires and the type of questions they put up, or the customer service team can provide an insight to the pain areas of the customers and can also help in providing the keywords which can be used for SEO purposes.

2. Gather Data Using MarTech Tools

- To help in building a foundation of information, ranging from demographic data to personal traits, there are plenty of tools to help gather data about the target audience.
- Below are a few of those tools and what they do:
 1. **YouGov:** YouGov Ratings measures the popularity and fame of anything and everything, based on millions of responses from the American public.
 2. **Demographics Pro:** This tool will analyze Twitter and Instagram profiles to give insights into the followers. It also allows to analyze competitor profiles and provides large amount of data.

The most popular phone models in America

YouGov Ratings measures the popularity and fame of anything and everything, based on millions of responses from the American public. [Explore YouGov Ratings](#)

All

Millennials

Gen X

Baby Boomers

Men

Women

1



MODEL OF PHONE

Galaxy S7

👍 47%

Most popular phone model

[Explore fan data](#)

2



MODEL OF PHONE

Galaxy Note 8

👍 46%

2nd most popular phone model

[Explore fan data](#)

3. Research Social Networks

1. **Use Social Analytics:** Facebook Insights (part of Facebook page) and Twitter Analytics (go to the *Followers* tab) will tell a lot about audience demographics and what they are interested in.
2. **Follow Hashtags** – On social networks, people share their feelings, pain points and needs freely – and all companies need to do is listen and analyze.
 - Software solutions like Tweetdeck and Hootsuite let companies subscribe to a number of hashtags relevant to a website or industry.
 - That way companies can see all tweets that are published with these hashtags attached and should quickly gather what people are thinking.

3. Join Groups and Communities – Birds of a feather flock together.

- It is only natural for any audience to come together in interest groups.
- Whether on LinkedIn, Google+ or elsewhere, try to find out the top three or four groups that ideal customer engages with.
- Then observe and join the conversation to find out more about them.

4. Conduct Interviews

- Being a time-consuming yet very effective qualitative research method is to conduct interviews.
- Interviews are generally conducted on a smaller group with pre- designed questions to mostly reveal the customers / prospects:
 - Personality traits
 - Buying preferences
 - Interests
 - Motivations

Digital Marketing & Transformation (BCAE0005)



Lecture -8

1.2.3.Construct Prospective Buyer Personas & Journeys

- Personas, which are “behavioral, demographic and psychological profile of audience groups”.

Below is a sample template to create a marketing persona

- Name – In order to distinguish your different personas
- Work
 - Size and type of company as well as industry they work in
 - Job description and details about their role
 - Responsibilities and people they answer to
- Demographics
- Age – Are your ideal visitors teenagers, twenty-somethings or silver surfers?
- Gender – Does your topic or product appeal more to a male or female demographic
- Salary – Think of this also in terms of buying power.
- Location – City dwellers or country folk?
- Education – Also think about this in terms of computer literacy.
- Family – What other roles do they fulfill, such as parents, grandparents etc.?
- Hobbies – How do they like to spend their free time?
- Interests – Blogs they read, where they get their news and so on.

- Goals and Challenges
 - What are their life goals?
 - What challenges are they facing on the way?
 - How can you help?
- Values and Fears
 - What is important to them?
 - What keeps them up at night?

1.2.4. Establishing the Content Ideation & Creation Framework

- Marketing team should always follow a content strategy which is equally understood by various content creators such as
 - copywriters,
 - designers,
 - producers,
 - analysts,
 - SEO experts etc.,
- to eliminate any confusion and streamline content creation across platforms.

- Primarily, there are two ways to succeed in content creation and promotion:
 - Be the first one to break a story, OR
 - Be the best one to tell it (10x Content)

10x Content: Content that is 10 times better than the best result that can currently be found in the search results for a given keyword phrase or topic.

- it means creating content that is so comprehensive, engaging, and valuable that it vastly surpasses the quality of competing content. This could involve:
- **More in-depth research and analysis:** Providing greater detail and insights than other sources.
- **Higher quality writing and presentation:** Using clear, concise language, compelling visuals, and a well-structured format.
- **Unique perspectives and insights:** Offering original viewpoints and interpretations.
- **Improved user experience:** Making the content easy to navigate, understand, and consume.
- By focusing on either being first or being the best (through 10x Content), content creators can increase their chances of attracting an audience, generating engagement, and achieving their goals.

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real-world business examples

- :
- **1. Be the First to Break a Story:**
- **Product Launch (First to Market):** Imagine a company developing a revolutionary new type of electric vehicle with significantly longer range and faster charging than anything currently available. If they are the first to announce and launch this product, they "break the story" in the automotive industry. This generates massive media attention, early adopter interest, and a strong first-mover advantage. Tesla, with its early focus on electric vehicles, is a good example of this. They weren't the *absolute* first EV company, but they were the first to make them desirable and mainstream.
- **Exclusive Research/Data:** A market research firm conducts a groundbreaking study revealing a previously unknown trend in consumer behavior. By publishing this data first, they become the go-to source for industry insights. This attracts media coverage, client inquiries, and establishes them as thought leaders. Think of Pew Research Center, when they release data on societal trends, they are often the first to publish that specific data set.

- **2. Be the Best to Tell It (10x Content):**
- **Comprehensive Guide/Tutorial:** A website selling coffee brewing equipment creates an incredibly detailed and comprehensive guide to brewing the perfect cup of coffee. This guide includes everything from bean selection and grinding techniques to different brewing methods and maintenance tips. This 10x content surpasses any simple blog post or product description available elsewhere, becoming a valuable resource for coffee enthusiasts. This attracts organic traffic from search engines, builds brand authority, and drives sales. Consider Serious Eats' detailed cooking guides and recipes as an example.
- **In-Depth Case Study:** A marketing agency creates a highly detailed case study showcasing how they helped a client achieve exceptional results through their marketing strategies. The case study includes specific data, metrics, and insights, demonstrating the agency's expertise and value proposition in a way that generic marketing materials cannot. This 10x content becomes a powerful sales tool, attracting high-quality leads.
- **Ultimate Resource List:** A personal finance website creates an extensive list of the best resources for managing personal finances, covering topics like budgeting, investing, debt management, and retirement planning. This list is meticulously curated, updated regularly, and includes detailed descriptions and reviews of each resource. This 10x content becomes a valuable hub for users seeking financial information, driving traffic to the website and establishing it as a trusted source. Think of websites like NerdWallet, which provide extensive resources and comparisons for financial products.
- In all these examples, "being the best" means providing significantly more value than competitors, whether through depth, quality, or comprehensiveness. This strategy builds long-term brand authority, attracts organic traffic, and fosters customer loyalty.

Tips to create a 10x content

- Attract and earns links
- Exemplify your expertise in your industry
- Rank for keywords/search terms that will have impact for your campaign
- Generate leads and customers for the business

Criteria for 10x Content

- a uniquely positive user experience through interface, colors, visuals, layout, fonts, patterns, etc.
- Delivers content of high-quality, trustworthy, useful, interesting, and remarkable value
- Is considerably different in scope and detail from other works on similar topics
- Loads quickly and is usable on any device or browser
- Creates an emotional response of wonder, surprise, joy, eagerness, and/or appreciation
- Has achieved an impressive quantity of amplification (through shares on social networks and/or links)
- Solves a problem or answers a question by providing complete, accurate, exceptional information or resources.

Examples of 10x content

- <https://www.bloomberg.com/graphics/2015-paul-ford-what-is-code/>
- <http://www.r2d3.us/visual-intro-to-machine-learning-part-1/>
- <https://edition.cnn.com/interactive/2015/03/opinion/ctl-child-poverty/#0>
- <https://clickclickclick.click/#9bffa0e3cd15afe541cc4d635f9eaba7>
- <https://www.nationalgeographic.com/travel/contests/photographer-of-the-year-2018/wallpapers/winners-all/5/>

How to Brainstorm Content Ideas

- Every content needs an idea,
- a unique identifier which can be linked to customer personas
- it would act as a catalyst between the audience and the company.

- Below are a few major sources from where content creators can get the initiation ideas:
 - Industry-specific articles
 - YouTube
 - SlideShare
 - Competitors' websites
 - Popular forums & communities in your space

The key aspects of content planning

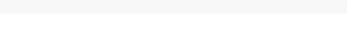
1. Check Topic/Keyword Search Volume:

- Support the content with data.
- Use Google's Keyword Planner to get an idea of how many people search for the topic.
- Companies can either bid for the hot topics
or
- Create their own topic/keyword combination to maximize the reach of the content.

Keywords

Add around 15-20 keywords. 

These are the search terms that may trigger your ad to appear next to search results.

Keyword	Search popularity 	
gla	 450000	
university	 673000	
uni	 450000	
gla university	 22200	
online universities	 74000	
delhi college of engineering	 9900	
b tech courses	 12100	
engineering colleges	 40500	
universities	 74000	

→ ↻ https://ads.google.com/um/GetStarted/Home?_u=1722325880&_c=3114033878&authuser=0

Text ad**Landing page**

<http://www.gla.ac.in>

Headline 1

Best Engineering College

Headline 2

No 1 university in India

Headlines can appear on the same or separate lines. Try to write them so they make sense when read together and separately.
Tip: Include one or two keywords in your headlines.

Description

Best engineering, management college, great job opportunity.

Ad preview

Best Engineering College - No 1 university in India

Ad [gla.ac.in](http://www.gla.ac.in)

Best engineering, management college, great job opportunity.



✓ About your business — ✓ Your first campaign — 3 Payment

Payment

Provide your payment information below. Remember, you won't be charged until your ad starts showing and people start clicking it.

Your ad

Best Engineering College - No 1 university in India

Ad gla.ac.in

Best engineering, management college, great job opportunity.

Your ad could be formatted differently to fit a user's device, but your ad text will stay the same.

Daily potential reach

320+ Clicks

Budget and bidding

Rs.1,000.00 daily budget

Google Ads automatically sets your bids to help you get as many clicks as possible within your budget.

Dashboard > Keyword Analytics > Keyword Magic Tool > List 1

Keyword Magic Tool: List 1 ^{NEW}[→ Go to Keyword Analy](#)

GLA Univer... x

India

+ New keyword

GLA University Mathura

IN v

Apply

Broad Match

Phrase Match

Exact Match

Related

All

Questions

Advanced filters v

By num of keywords

By volume

All keywords 98

> admission	6	👁
> fees	5	👁
> rank	5	👁
> course	4	👁
> entrance	4	👁
> near	4	👁
hostel	3	👁
full	3	👁
structure	3	👁
contact	3	👁

All keywords

Total volume **3,790** | Average difficulty **0.75%**

Export

☐	Keyword v	Volume v	Trend	KD v	CPC v	Com. v
☐	gla university mathura	2,900		73.81	0.1	0.03
☐	gla university mathura fee structure	110		n/a	0	0.01
☐	gla university mathura uttar pradesh	110		n/a	0	0
☐	how to get admission in gla university mathura	90		n/a	0	0
☐	indian overseas bank gla university mathura	90		n/a	0	0.05
☐	gla university mathura mba	40		n/a		

Have a

- **What the Tool Shows:**
- **Keywords:** These are the words and phrases people type into search engines when looking for information. In this case, they're related to GLA University.
- **Volume:** This indicates how many times a keyword is searched per month. Higher volume means more potential traffic.
- .

- **How Businesses Use Keyword Research:**

- 1. Understanding Customer Language:** Keyword research helps businesses understand the exact words and phrases their target audience uses when searching for products or services.
 - 1. Example:** Instead of assuming people search for "college," GLA University might find that people also search for "university," "institute," "admission in [city]," or specific course names like "B.Tech in Computer Science."
- 2. Creating Relevant Content (10x Content):** By knowing what people are searching for, businesses can create content that directly addresses those needs. This is the core of "Be the Best to Tell It."
 - 1. Example:** If many people search for "gla university mathura fee structure," the university can create a detailed and easily accessible page on their website outlining all fees, payment options, and financial aid information. This 10x content is far more valuable than a simple mention of fees on a general information page.

- **Improving Search Engine Rankings:**

. When websites use relevant keywords in their content, meta descriptions, and other on-page elements, they are more likely to rank higher in search results. This drives organic (free) traffic to the website.

Example: By using keywords like "gla university admission," "gla university courses," and "gla university ranking" naturally within their website content, GLA University can improve its visibility in search results when people search for those terms.

Optimizing Paid Advertising Campaigns:

Keyword research is essential for creating effective paid advertising campaigns (like Google Ads). By targeting the right keywords, businesses can ensure their ads are shown to the right people, maximizing their return on investment.

Example: GLA University could run Google Ads targeting keywords like "best engineering colleges in Mathura" or "MBA programs in Uttar Pradesh" to attract prospective students.

Identifying Content Gaps:

Keyword research can reveal topics that are relevant to a business but not adequately covered by existing content (either on their own website or on competitor websites). This provides opportunities to create 10x content that fills these gaps.

- **Example:** If the research shows a lot of searches for "gla university hostel life" but there's limited information available, the university could create a blog post, photo gallery, or video tour showcasing the hostel facilities and student experiences. **Connecting to "Be the Best to Tell It":**
- Keyword research provides the foundation for creating 10x content. By understanding what people are searching for, businesses can create content that is:
- **More relevant:** Directly answers user queries.
- **More comprehensive:** Provides more in-depth information than competitors.
- **More engaging:** Uses the language and style that resonates with the target audience.
- In short, keyword research helps businesses create content that is truly "10 times better" than the competition, driving organic traffic, building brand authority, and ultimately achieving business goals.

2. Check for Existing Link Opportunities:

- Review the top ranking pages for the topic you want to build content on.
- See if the ranking pages have substantial # of links pointing to them.
- **page rank:** a value assigned to a web page as a measure of its popularity or importance, used to determine the order in which search engine results(SERPs) are presented.

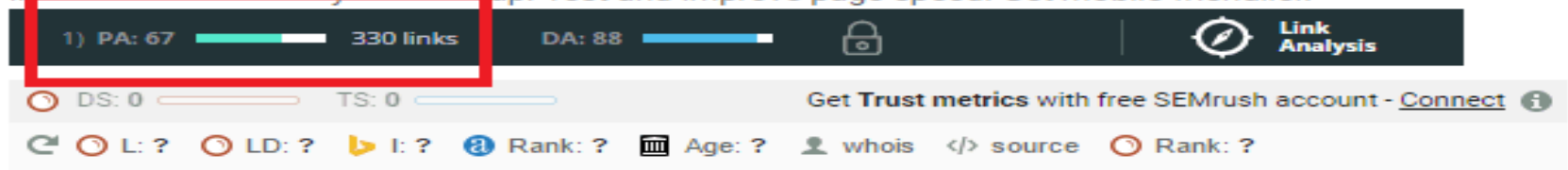
- **What is a "Top Ranking Page"?**
- A "top ranking page" is a web page that appears high in the search engine results pages (SERPs) for a specific search query. It means the search engine (like Google) considers that page to be the most relevant and authoritative source of information for that particular search.
- **Example:**
- Let's say you search for "best coffee makers for home."
- The pages that appear on the first page of Google's search results are the "top ranking pages" for that search query. These pages are likely to have:
- Relevant content about coffee makers.
- Good website authority (a measure of a website's credibility and trustworthiness).
- A strong backlink profile (a significant number of high-quality links pointing to them).
- Good user experience (fast loading speed, mobile-friendliness, easy navigation).

Use MozBar extension in chrome

1. Technical SEO checklist: 7 essential tips to implement now for 2017 ✓

searchengineland.com/technical-seo-checklist-7-essential-tips-2017-263936 ▼

Nov 29, 2016 - Let's get rollin! Check indexing. Let's start with the number of your site's pages that are indexed by search engines. Make sure important resources are crawlable. Optimize crawl budget. Audit internal links. Review your sitemap. Test and improve page speed. Get mobile-friendlier.

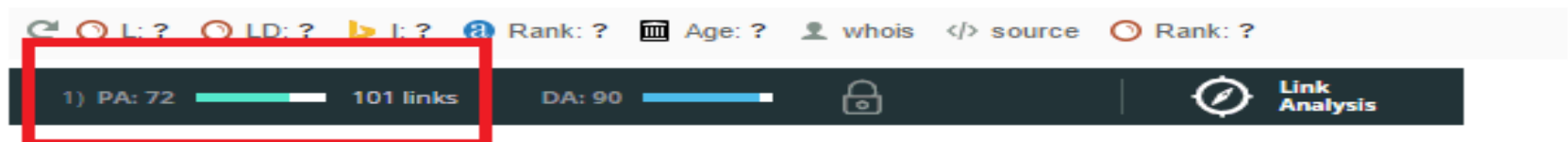


The MozBar extension interface for searchengineland.com shows the following metrics: 1) PA: 67 (with a green progress bar), 330 links, DA: 88 (with a blue progress bar), and a Link Analysis icon. Below this, it displays DS: 0, TS: 0, and a link to 'Get Trust metrics with free SEMrush account - Connect'. The bottom bar includes icons for L: ?, LD: ?, I: ?, Rank: ?, Age: ?, whois, source, and another Rank: ?.

2. Technical Site Audit Checklist: 2015 Edition - Moz ✓

<https://moz.com/blog/technical-site-audit-for-2015> ▼

Jan 19, 2015 - Back in 2011, I wrote a a **technical site audit checklist**, and while it was thorough, there have ... **SEO Copywriting Tips for Improved Link Building**

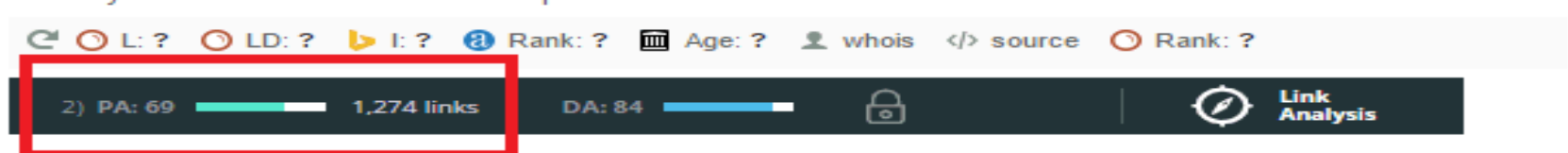


The MozBar extension interface for moz.com shows the following metrics: 1) PA: 72 (with a green progress bar), 101 links, DA: 90 (with a blue progress bar), and a Link Analysis icon. The bottom bar includes icons for L: ?, LD: ?, I: ?, Rank: ?, Age: ?, whois, source, and another Rank: ?.

3. Technical SEO checklist: a webmaster's guide to on-page optimisation ... ✓

<https://searchenginewatch.com> > SEO ▼

Oct 20, 2016 - Presenting a guide to carrying out all the on-page checks that webmasters and SEOs need to carry out to ensure a website is optimised for ...



The MozBar extension interface for searchenginewatch.com shows the following metrics: 2) PA: 69 (with a green progress bar), 1,274 links, DA: 84 (with a blue progress bar), and a Link Analysis icon. The bottom bar includes icons for L: ?, LD: ?, I: ?, Rank: ?, Age: ?, whois, source, and another Rank: ?.

- **What is Technical SEO?**
- Technical SEO is about making sure search engines can easily find, understand, and index your website. It's like preparing your house for a visitor – you want to make it easy for them to find the front door, get inside, and see all the rooms.
- The important parts are highlighted in red:
- PA (Page Authority): This is a score (out of 100) that predicts how well a specific page will rank in search results. Higher is better.
- DA (Domain Authority): This is a score (out of 100) that predicts how well an entire website will rank in search results. Higher is better.
- Links: This shows the number of backlinks (links from other websites) pointing to that page. More high-quality links generally mean higher authority and better ranking.

3. Check for the Influencers:

- Are there existing content amplifiers who will be willing to promote the content once it is published (by sharing or linking to it) –if given, then is it 10x better than what they have shared or linked to in the past?
- Reach out to them once your content goes live.

4. Evergreen Topic Litmus Test:

- One way to make the most out of the content ideas/assets is to ensure that they can provide value to its intended audience for a long time.
- Search trends can be used to determine the durability of the topic (use Google Trends).

- Because of its enduring online visibility and efficient scaling-through natural linking, evergreen content works best for any kind of content marketing campaigns.
- Content should be constantly monitored and updated to sustain the rankings.

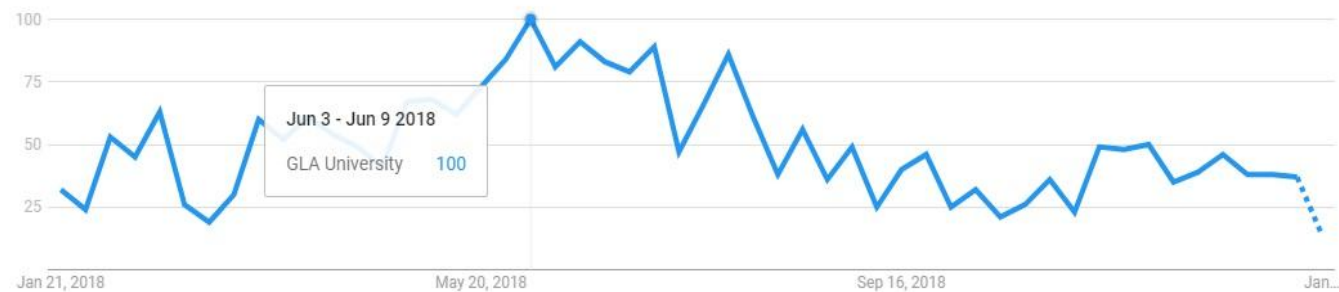
Google Trends Explore

GLA University
Search term

+ Compare

India Past 12 months All categories Web Search

Interest over time



Desktop Libraries atul Computer Network Control Pa... Recycle Bin Control Pa... AVG AntiV... Spyder 8:42 PM Wednesday 1/16/2019

5. UNIQUE VALUE. WHAT'S MISSING FROM YOUR COMPETITORS' CONTENT?

- Review your competitors' content.
- Can you add something about the topic that hasn't been written or mentioned from their content, or better – elsewhere?
- In which you can incorporate the following:
 - Internal data
 - Case studies
 - Survey data

6. RANKABILITY – CAN WE RANK FOR THIS CONTENT/TOPIC'S SEARCH TERM(S)

- Make sure the content answers the below questions:
 1. Is the site enough consistent for the content to rank in a short period of time?
 2. What's the average site ranking within the top 10, for the target keyword(s)?
 3. How many links do we need to get to the top page of Google?
 4. How do we build links to this content?
 5. **Will influencers really link or share this content?**
 6. **Will this content idea be genuinely 10 times better than what's currently ranking #1 in Google?**

- If the last 2 questions can be answered confidently, there would be high chances of content being available to the top spectrum of search engines.

Digital Marketing & Transformation (BCAE0005)



Lecture -9

1.2.5 Creative Design Principles

- Creating a beautiful design is all about creating a harmony among the various design elements to combining the same with a great imagination, which then comes out as a final product.
- Use a wide variety of online and offline tools to create graphic designs.
- Design principles are the basic unit of any visual piece, like painting, drawing or designing that are into existence.

The design principles which should be followed when creating any graphic

- LINE
- COLOR
- SHAPE
- TEXTURE
- SIZE & SCALE
- DIRECTION
- PROXIMITY
- BALANCE
- ALIGNMENT
- CONTRAST

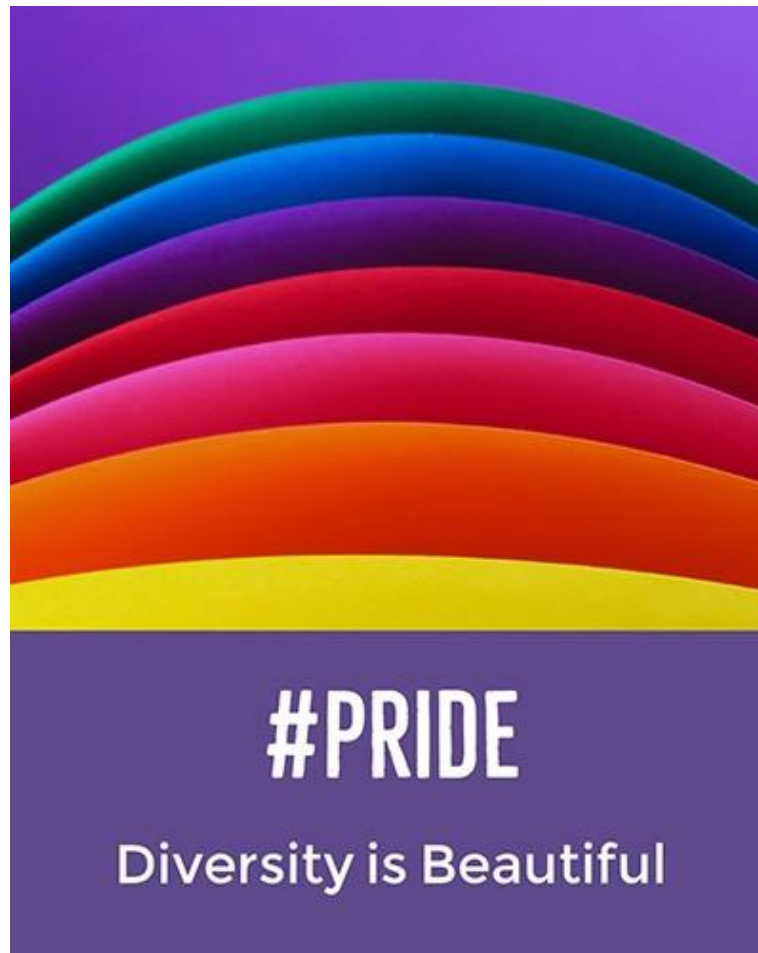
Alignment



Balance



Color



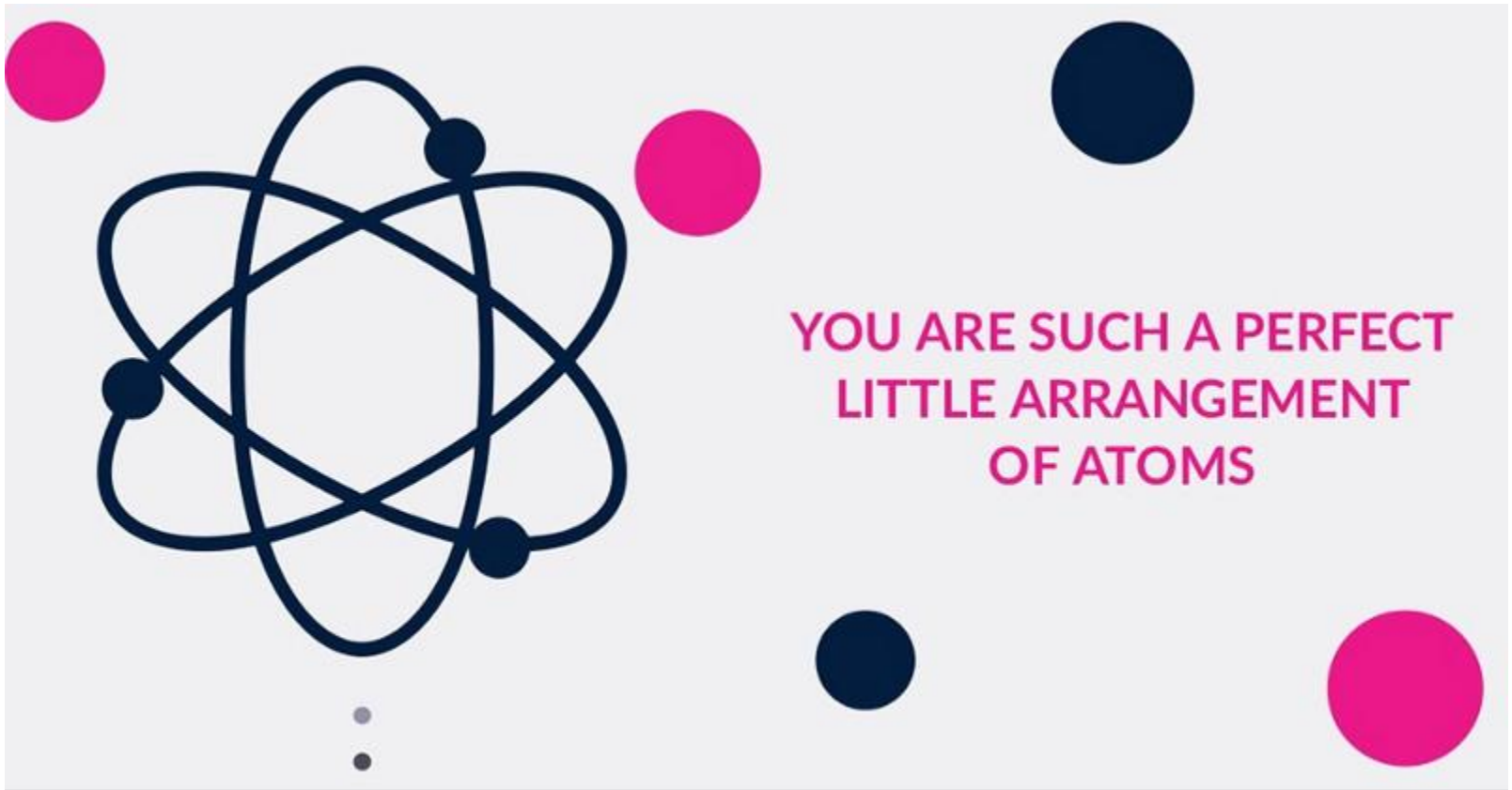
Contrast



Proximity



Proximity



1.2.6 Linking Blogs to Social Network (Conversation Blogs)

- Used by both big and small size companies
- To establish a strong online presence
- To redirect the audience to their website.
- Blogs can be great medium to express and write about a passion.
- It can be dedicated to life topics such as health and lifestyle, fitness etc.
- Blog promotion is key, irrespective whether it's an individual or a company concern.
- Also, social media websites have evolved, and it has become easy for the companies to promote blogs and increase traffic.

Ways to link the blogs to social networks:

- Create a social networking page for the Blog
- Add Blog Links to Social Media Profiles
- Schedule Tweets/Posts
- Focus on the Communities
 - Post Your Content in Several Groups
 - Message Your Connection in These Groups
- Embrace the Visual Power
 - Capture the Attention of Your Audience
 - Break the Text
 - Add Some Colors to It
- Don't be a Spammer

Essential of Digital Marketing (BCAE058)



Lecture -10

CONTENT PROMOTION

Content Promotion

- Goal is to attract a given target audience.
- It neither has any sales pitch nor does it try to directly advertise or sell a brand, product or service.
- **It aims to provide a lasting effect with:**
 - valuable, relevant information that is educational, entertaining and/or emotionally satisfying.
 - **Expand their customer base**
 - **Increase brand awareness or trustworthiness.**
 - **Engage an online community of users**

SEO – Search Engine Optimization

- **Definition:** SEO stands for **Search Engine Optimization**, which is the practice of increasing the *quantity* and *quality* of traffic to your website through *organic search engine results*.
- It is the process of getting traffic from the “free,” “organic,” “editorial” or “natural” search results on search engines.

- **Organic search** is a method for entering one or several **search** terms as a single string of text into a **search** engine.
- **Organic search** results, appear as paginated lists, are based on relevance to the **search** terms; and exclude advertisements.
- Whereas, non-**organic search** results do not filter out pay per click advertising.
- Imagine you're looking up "best pizza near me" on Google.
- **Organic search results** are like the list of pizza places Google shows you based on how good their website is, how many people link to it, and how relevant it is to your search. These results are earned, not bought. They appear naturally because Google thinks they're the best matches for what you're looking for.
- **Non-organic search results** are the ads you see at the very top or bottom of the page, sometimes labeled as "Ad" or "Sponsored." These pizza places have paid Google to show their ad to you, even if their website isn't the most relevant. They're paying for visibility.
- So, in simple terms:
- **Organic = Natural, earned results based on relevance.**
- **Non-organic = Paid advertisements.**

Search Engines

- A search engine is a program that identifies files (weblinks and related information) in its database based on a keyword (search query) added by the user and returns results accordingly.
- The common search engines being used are Google, Yahoo, Bing etc.

Why are Search engines important for businesses:

- Search engines are usually the first point of contact for anyone when it comes to finding what they want online,
- The statistics show that **over 40%** go on to make a purchase / conversion.
- If a website isn't optimized for specific keywords search listing, then it is practically invisible to your online target audience.
- Having **an effective and useful website** would act like a **24-hour online sales representative** that will be consistently available to prospective clients.
- Appearing in the **search engine's natural listings is completely free of charge making** search engine optimization extremely cost effective and producing a positive ROI.

- 75% of searchers start their searches on Google.

<https://www.zerolimitweb.com>

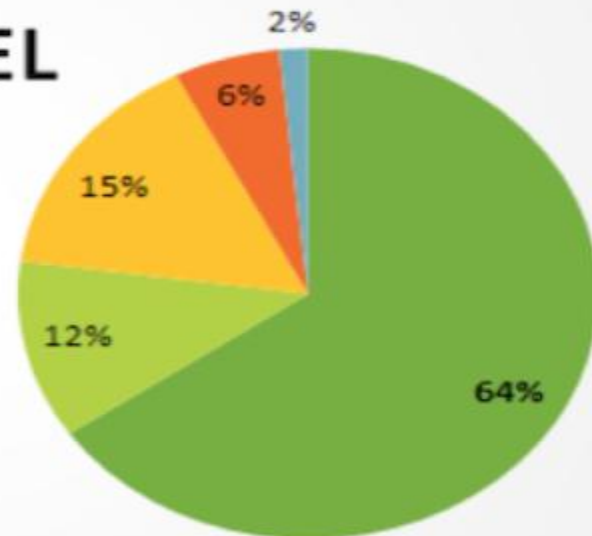
- the first five results on Google get 67% of all clicks,

<https://www.netmarketshare.com/search-engine-market-share.aspx>



WEB VISIT CHANNEL DISTRIBUTION BY CHANNEL

- Organic Search
- Direct
- Referral (w/o Social)
- Paid Search
- Social



- There's a joke going around the web that highlights how crucial it is to hit the first page of Google:
- **If you ever need to hide a dead body, you should place it on the second page of Google search results.**

Essential of Digital Marketing (BCAE058)



Lecture -11

1.3.1. Implementing SEO as ART and as Science

Here are 4 ways why SEO is a science:

1. Research is required

- SEO without research is like swimming without water
 - it's required! SEO needs research within:
 - **Google's algorithm** (to understand the facts of how it works)
 - **Your website's audience** (to understand what kind of content they want)
 - **Keywords** (to understand what those people are searching for)

2. Numbers drive critical functions

- Numbers provide guidelines in some critical parts to SEO like:
 - **50 to 60** ([optimal character length of Meta Title](#))
 - **150 to 160** ([optimal character length of Meta Description](#))
 - **100** (having keyword in the first hundred words of a page's content is relevancy factor)
 - **115** or under (optimal URL length)
 - **4 or under** (the number of seconds your website should load)

Common SEO Mistakes – Strategy & Structure (pt. 1 of 2)  **Meta Title = 50 to 60**
www.protofuse.com/blog/common-seo-mistakes-strategy-structure/ ▼
Aug 15, 2014 - To avoid common SEO mistakes, take an 80/20 approach (Pareto Principle). Here are 5 to avoid with your strategy & structure.  **Meta Description = 155 or less**

3. Formulas are the brain of search engines

- Google's algorithm changes [500-600 times a year](#) and Google is on record for saying there are 200 different [ranking factors](#) (some more important than others).

4. Observation is ongoing

- Though an initial on-page optimization can last for years, SEO, in general is ongoing.
- You need to watch how your strategy unfolds, find new keywords, create new content, fix crawl errors and account for algorithm changes

Why SEO is an Art

- **Here are 4 ways why SEO is an Art:**

- 1. Compelling, Concise and Clickable Copy**

- The metadata that shows in the results page has a restriction on the number of characters.
- So, do you jam in as many keywords as possible? Or, do you write convincing copy that'll get clicks? If you approach your SEO artfully, you'll do the latter.

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2. Clear, Smart Keyword Hierarchy & Structure

What option will drive better SEO results?

A: Throw every keyword applicable to your business on every page of your site?

B: Design an architecture that places keywords on individual pages?

Correct answer = ?

3. Not falling victim to generically naming links “Click Here”

- Naming your links “click here” negatively impacts SEO (<http://uxmovement.com/content/why-your-links-should-never-say-click-here/>).
- It lacks the artful approach that search engine bots are seeking to understand how content and pages connect.

 [Click for a Demo](#)

 [View Demo](#)

 Scamworld is available on the Kindle Store. You can download it right **here**.

 You can download **Scamworld on the Kindle Store**.

4. UX now impacts SEO (and great UX demands an artful approach)

- Your website's [UX is now a mobile ranking factor](#) (and may impact desktop rankings in the future, possibly).
- In other words, bad mobile design = bad mobile rankings.

← Mobile-Friendly Test

🌐 <http://www.gla.ac.in/>

← Page loading info

Tested on: Jan 16, 2019 at 10:06 PM

Page partially loaded

Not all page resources could be loaded. This can affect how Google sees and understands your page. Fix availability problems for any resources that can affect how Google understands your page.

🎓 [LEARN MORE](#)

Details



User agent

Googlebot smartphone



37 page resources couldn't be loaded



Digital Marketing & Transformation (BCAE0005)



Lecture -12

1.3.2. Ranking Algorithms

- A good search engine does not attempt to return the pages that best match the input query.
- Search Engines like Google use many elements and aspects, commonly referred to as “signals” in their algorithm to determine relevance.

1.3.2. Ranking Algorithms

- A good search engine like Google doesn't simply look for exact matches to your query. It aims to understand the intent behind your search and provide the most relevant and useful results, even if those results don't contain the exact words you used.
- Here's a breakdown of why and how:
- **Why not just exact matches?**
- **Synonyms and related terms:** People use different words to express the same idea. If you search for "best running shoes," you likely also want results about "top athletic footwear" or "good jogging sneakers."
- **Context and meaning:** Words can have multiple meanings. A search for "apple" could be about the fruit or the tech company. A good search engine considers the context of your search to determine the correct meaning.
- **User intent:** What are you really trying to find? Are you looking for information, a product to buy, a specific website, or something else? The search engine tries to infer your intent to provide the most appropriate results.

- Such signals are
 - the usage of the term in the Title tag,
 - Heading,
 - URL
 - the proximity of the keyword to the beginning of the content.
- Others include such things as
 - links from other websites;
 - the relevance of the page the link originates from;
 - the text of the link and the page that link is pointing to.
- Google states that they utilize over 200 signals in their ranking algorithms.

1. Text-Based Ranking Algorithm

- It finds how similar each sentence is to all other sentences in the text.
- It extracts words from sentences and follows the same algorithm,
- Using a similarity function between words that can be used to TextRank with extracted keywords from the text.
- The idea is that **the word is most similar to all the other words** and hence the **most important one**.

- a type of search engine algorithm that primarily relies on the text content of web pages to determine their relevance to a search query and rank them in search results.
- These algorithms analyze various textual elements to understand the topic and context of a page. Here are some key aspects of text-based ranking algorithms:

Keyword Analysis: This is a fundamental aspect. The algorithm analyzes the presence, frequency, and location of keywords within the content (title, headings, body text, meta descriptions, etc.) to assess relevance.

- **What is Keyword Analysis?**
- Imagine you're in a library, looking for a book on "cooking Italian pasta." You'd probably search the library catalog using those specific words. Similarly, search engines like Google use keywords to understand what a webpage is about.
- **How does Keyword Analysis work?**
- When you create a webpage, you strategically use keywords to tell search engines what your content is about. The search engine then uses these keywords to rank your page in search results.
- **Here's a breakdown of the text:**
- **"Keyword Analysis: This is a fundamental aspect":** This means that understanding and using keywords is crucial for SEO.
- **"The algorithm analyzes the presence, frequency, and location of keywords":** Search engines have algorithms (complex sets of rules) that scan your webpage for keywords. They look at how often these words appear, where they appear (in the title, headings, body text, etc.), and if they are used naturally.
- **Example:**
- Let's say you have a blog post about "making homemade pizza." You'd want to use keywords like "**homemade pizza**," "pizza recipe," "pizza dough," "pizza toppings" throughout your post. You might also include these keywords in your page title, headings, and image descriptions.

1. Text-Based Ranking Algorithm

Semantic Analysis: This goes beyond simple keyword matching. It attempts to understand the meaning and context of words and phrases. Techniques like Latent Semantic Indexing (LSI) and Natural Language Processing (NLP) are used to identify related concepts and synonyms, improving the algorithm's ability to understand the topic even if the exact keywords aren't present.

Proximity and Phrase Matching: The algorithm considers the proximity of keywords to each other. If the search query is a phrase (e.g., "**best Italian restaurants**"), the algorithm gives higher weight to pages where those words appear close together

.Content Structure: The way content is organized also matters. The use of headings (H1, H2, etc.), lists, and other formatting elements helps the algorithm understand the hierarchy and structure of the content.

1. Text-Based Ranking Algorithm

- **Limitations of purely text-based algorithms:**
- **Susceptibility to keyword stuffing:** Early search engines that relied heavily on keyword matching were easily manipulated by "keyword stuffing," where websites would excessively repeat keywords to artificially boost their rankings.
- **Difficulty understanding context:** These algorithms could struggle with understanding the true meaning of text, especially with ambiguous or nuanced language.
- **Ignoring other important factors:** They didn't consider other crucial ranking factors like link quality, user experience, and website authority.

Ranking Parameters

- Summarizing Text
- How many sentences to use in the summary
- Which similarity function use to compare sentences

<https://www.analyticsvidhya.com/blog/2018/11/introduction-text-summarization-textrank-python/>

2. Hyperlink Induced Topic Search (HITS)

- It is a link analysis algorithm that rates Web pages.

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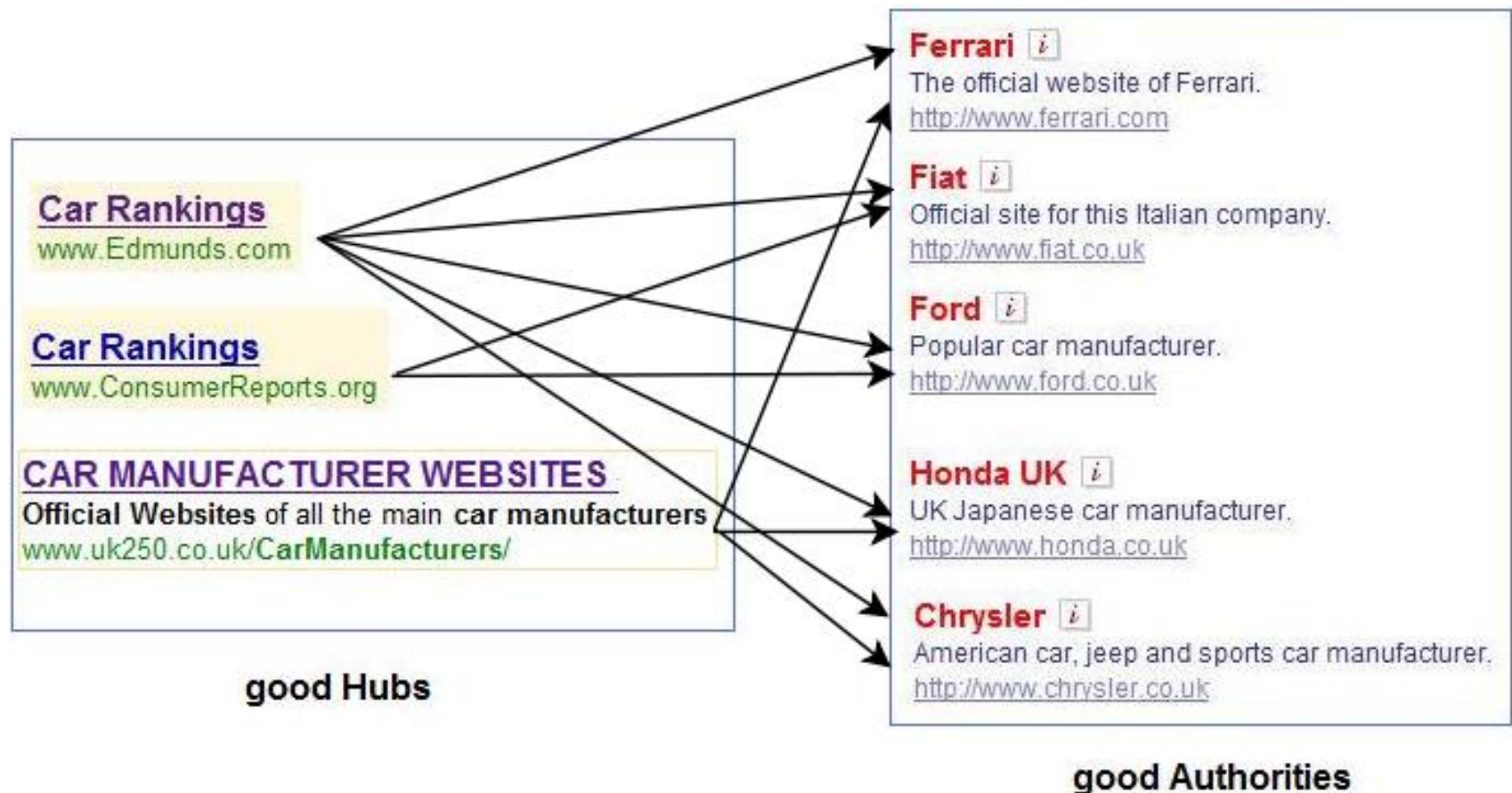
- HITS is a **link analysis algorithm**, meaning it uses the structure of hyperlinks (connections between web pages) to determine the importance or relevance of pages.
- Unlike other algorithms (e.g., Google's PageRank, which assigns a single score to each page), HITS assigns **two scores** to each page:
 - A **hub score**: Measures how well a page links to other authoritative pages.
 - An **authority score**: Measures how well a page is

2. Hyperlink Induced Topic Search (HITS)

- **Example of an Authority Page:**
- **Topic:** "Best Electric Toothbrushes"
- **Authority Page:** A comprehensive review article on a reputable consumer electronics website like Wirecutter or CNET. These pages often include in-depth research, comparisons, and expert opinions.
- **Example of a Hub Page:**
- **Topic:** "Electric Toothbrush Buying Guide"
- **Hub Page:** A blog post or article that provides an overview of different electric toothbrush types, features to consider, and links to several authority pages (like the Wirecutter review) for further information.

HITS

- Certain web pages, known as hubs,
- Hubs served as large directories
- Hubs are reliable in the information that they held,
- Hubs are used as compilations of a broad catalog of information that led users direct to other authoritative pages.
- A good hub represented a page that pointed to many other pages
- A good authority represented a page that was linked by many different hubs.



Query: **Top automobile makers**

Here's a breakdown in simple terms:

Hubs:

- **Think of a hub as a central point that connects many different things.** Imagine a train station (a hub) with many train lines (different routes) going out from it.
- **On a website, a hub page is a main page about a broad topic.** It gives an overview and then links to more specific pages with detailed information.

Example: A website about "healthy eating" might have a hub page called "Nutrition Basics." This page would explain the main food groups, vitamins, minerals, etc., and then link to other pages like "Best Sources of Protein," "Healthy Recipes for Breakfast," or "Understanding Food Labels."

Authorities:

- **An authority is someone or something that is seen as an expert or reliable source of information.** Think of a doctor who is an authority on medical issues.
- **On the internet, a website becomes an authority when it has a lot of high-quality content that people find useful and trustworthy.** Search engines like Googlea also consider how many other reputable websites link to it.
- **Example:** A website run by a well-known medical university with lots of research articles and expert advice would be considered an authority on health and medicine.

How Hubs Build Authority:

- **By creating hub pages, you organize your website's content in a logical way, making it easier for users to find what they need.** This improves user experience, which is something search engines like.

In short: Hub pages act as central points that organize your content and make it more accessible. This, in turn, helps build your website's authority by demonstrating expertise and providing a better user experience.

HITS

HITS concludes two main values for a page:

- 1) Page Authority: which estimates the value of the content of the page
- 2) Page hub value: which estimates value of its links to other pages.

Jon Kleinberg develop the **HITS** (*hyperlink-induced topic search*) algorithm which is now part of the **Ask** search engine

3. PageRank Algorithm

- PageRank is an algorithm used by the Google search engine to measure the authority of a webpage.

According to Google:

- *PageRank works by counting the number and quality of links to a page to determine a rough estimate of how important the website is.*
- *The underlying assumption is that more important websites are likely to receive more links from other websites.*

- Page Rank algorithm assumes that **if a page has a link to another page then it votes for that page.**
- Therefore, each **inlink to a page** raises its **importance.**
- PageRank is a recursive algorithm in which the PageRank of a page depends upon the PageRank of the pages linking to it.
- Thus, not only the number of inlinks of a page influences its ranking but also the page ranks of the pages linking to it.

- an **inlink**, also known as a backlink, incoming link, or internal link (depending on the context), is a hyperlink on one website that points to another website or a different page on the same website.
- **Here's a breakdown of the different types and their significance:**
- **External Inlinks (Backlinks):** These are links from other websites to your website. They are crucial for SEO. Search engines treat backlinks as votes of confidence. The more high-quality backlinks you have from reputable websites, the more authoritative and trustworthy your website appears to search engines, which can lead to higher search rankings.
- **Example:** A blog post on a popular cooking website links to your recipe page. This is an external inlink (backlink) to your site.

- **Internal Inlinks:** These are links that point to other pages within the same website. They are important for: Navigation: Helping users easily navigate your website and find relevant information.
- **Distributing link equity (PageRank):** Passing "link juice" or authority from one page to another within your site, helping to improve the ranking of other pages.
- **Improving user experience:** Encouraging users to explore more of your content, increasing engagement and time on site. **Example:** On your "About Us" page, you link to your "Contact Us" page. This is an internal inlink.

- **Why are inlinks important in digital marketing?**
- **SEO (Search Engine Optimization):** Backlinks are a major ranking factor for search engines. They signal relevance, authority, and trustworthiness.
- **Referral Traffic:** Inlinks from other websites can drive direct traffic to your website.
- **Brand Building:** Earning backlinks from reputable sources can enhance your brand's credibility and reputation.
- **User Experience:** Internal linking improves website navigation and helps users find relevant information, leading to better user engagement

- PageRank is often considered to be a number between 0 and 10 (with 0 being the lowest and 10 being the highest) though that is also probably incorrect.
- This is a rough approximation, as Google does not release its most up to date PageRank as a way of protecting the algorithm's details.
- Finally, and perhaps most importantly, PageRank is just one of many factors that Google uses to decide where a site appears in search rankings for a particular query.

- Brin and Page developed a ranking algorithm at Stanford University named PageRank after Larry Page.
- Page Rank algorithm uses link structure to determine the importance of web page.
- This algorithm is based on random surfer model.
- The random surfer model assumes that a user randomly keeps on clicking the links on a page and if she/he get bored of a page then switches to another page randomly.
- Thus, a user under this model shows no bias towards any page or link.
- PageRank(PR) is the probability of a page being visited by such user under this model.

- PageRank Intuition
 - “Page is important if many important pages point to it”
 - Many pages point to Yahoo!, so it is “important”
 - Because Yahoo! is important, anyone it prominently points to is “important”

4. Weighted Page Rank Algorithm

- **Wenpu Xing** and **Ali Ghorbani** projected a Weighted PageRank (WPR) algorithm which is a **modification to the PageRank algorithm**.
- This algorithm **assigns a larger rank values to the more important pages** rather than dividing the rank value of a page evenly among its outgoing linked pages.
- Each **outgoing link** gets a **value proportional to its importance**.
- The **importance is assigned in terms of weight values to the incoming and outgoing links**.
- The results of simulation studies show that WPR performs better than the conventional PageRank algorithm in terms of returning a larger number of relevant pages to a given query.

4. Weighted Page Rank Algorithm

- Weighted PageRank is like a smarter way of ranking web pages. It considers the strength of links, giving more importance to links from authoritative sources. This results in a ranking that is more aligned with the actual importance and relevance of web pages.

how we manage or give importance to some pages over others:

- **Link Analysis:** Identifying Authoritative Sources: We identify websites or pages that are considered reliable and trustworthy sources of information.
- These could be:**Government websites: (.gov)** **University websites: (.edu)** Renowned news organizations: (e.g., BBC, CNN, The New York Times) Industry-leading publications: (e.g., scientific journals, trade magazines)
- **Assigning Weights:** We assign higher weights to links originating from these authoritative sources. This signifies that a link from a highly reputable source carries more weight in determining the importance of the linked page.

how we manage or give importance to some pages over others:

Content Quality:

- **Evaluating Content:** The quality of content on a page plays a crucial role. Pages with high-quality, original, and informative content are generally considered more important.
- **Keyword Relevance:** Pages that are highly relevant to specific keywords or search queries are given more importance. This is determined through techniques like keyword research and on-page optimization.

• **User Behavior:**

- **User Engagement:** Pages with high user engagement (e.g., high bounce rates, low time on page) are considered less important. Conversely, pages with high user engagement (e.g., low bounce rates, high time on page) are considered more important.
- **User Interaction:** Factors like click-through rates (CTR) from search engine results pages (SERPs) and social media shares can also influence a page's perceived importance.

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how we manage or give importance to some pages over others:

Technical Factors:

Website Structure: A well-structured website with clear navigation and a user-friendly design is generally considered more important.

Mobile-Friendliness: In today's mobile-first world, mobile-friendly websites are given higher importance by search engines.

Page Loading Speed: Faster loading times improve user experience and can positively impact a page's ranking.

5. Distance Ranking Algorithm

- It is a novel recursive method based on reinforcement learning which considers distance between pages as punishment, called “DistanceRank” to compute ranks of web pages.
- The **distance is defined as minimum number of average clicks** that a user requires to reach **from page i to another page j**.
- Since related pages have been usually linked to each other, the distanced based solution can find pages with high qualities more quickly.
- In other words, each page that has less average distance from others has a higher rank.
- The objective is to minimize punishment or distance so that a page with less distance to have a higher rank.

6. Topic Sensitive Page Ranking Algorithm

- **Topic-Sensitive PageRank** (commonly referred to as TSPR) is a context-sensitive ranking algorithm for web search developed by Taher Haveliwala while at Stanford University.
- Thought to be used by Google for the purpose of indexing and ranking search results in the search engine results pages, although no evidence has been shown of it in practice.
- **Imagine the web as a library with different sections:**
- **Pages are books:** Each webpage is like a book in the library.
- **Links are shelves:** Links between pages are like shelves connecting books.
- **Topics are sections:** The library is divided into sections like "History," "Science," and "Literature."
- **TSPR:** Is like finding the most important books within each specific section (History, Science, Literature, etc.).

- **Topic-Sensitive PageRank** is a smarter way of ranking web pages. It considers the topic of your search and gives you more relevant results by focusing on the importance of pages within that specific topic.
- TSPR is like having specialized rankings for different topics. It gives more accurate results for specific searches. It's like having a librarian who knows which books are the most important within each section.
- **Here's how it works:**
 1. **Pre-computing scores:** TSPR first calculates the importance of each book (page) for each section (topic).
 2. **Query time:** When you search for a topic (e.g., "History"), TSPR combines the scores of books that are relevant to "History" to give you the most important "History" books.

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Lecture -13

1.3.3. Website Audit

- When a user enters a search query and if the size of the query is lengthy, it is difficult for the search engine to match all the keywords present in the query.
- The user refines the query until he gets the required results.
- The most challenging issue in most of the search engines is retrieval of most relevant web pages which are arranged from top to bottom based on the user preference and ranking.
- A **website audit by the search engines** comprises of **Web Mining, Crawling, Indexing and Ranking** on websites to assess and to provide better placement in search results.

Web Mining

- **Web mining** is the application of data mining techniques to discover patterns from the World Wide Web.
- It makes utilization of automated tools to reveal and extract data from servers and web2 reports,
- It permits organizations to get to both organized and unstructured information from browser activities, server logs, website and link structure, page content and different sources.

Here's a breakdown of what web mining does:

1. Data Collection: It gathers data from various sources like:

1. Browser activities: What websites people visit, how long they stay, what they click on.

2. Server logs: Records of website traffic, user requests, and errors.

3. Website structure: How web pages are linked together.

4. Page content: Text, images, videos on web pages.

5. Social media: Posts, comments, likes, shares.

Data Analysis: It uses sophisticated techniques to analyze the collected data, such as:

- **Data mining algorithms:** To identify trends, patterns, and relationships in the data.
- **Machine learning:** To build models that can predict future behavior or make informed decisions.
- **Natural language processing:** To understand and interpret the meaning of text data.

Insight Generation: It extracts valuable insights from the analyzed data, such as:

- **User behavior:** Understanding how users interact with websites.
- **Market trends:** Identifying emerging trends and consumer preferences.
- **Competitive analysis:** Gaining insights into competitors' strategies.
- **Personalized recommendations:** Providing tailored recommendations to users.

"web2 reports" likely refers to reports that analyze data generated by web 2.0 technologies. Web 2.0 is a term that describes the second major phase of the World Wide Web, characterized by user-generated content, social networking, and interactive services. Examples of data included in "web2 reports" might include:

Social media analytics: Analyzing data from platforms like Facebook, Twitter, and Instagram to understand user sentiment, engagement, and reach.

Website traffic analytics: Tracking website traffic, user behavior, and conversion rates using tools like Google Analytics.

E-commerce analytics: Analyzing online sales data, customer behavior, and marketing campaigns to optimize online stores. **Blog and forum analysis:** Analyzing user discussions and comments to understand public opinion and identify emerging trends.

- Web Mining: can be further classified into below categories:
 1. Web Usage Mining
 2. Web Content Mining
 3. Web Structure Mining

1. Web Usage Mining

Web usage mining

- This is the process of extracting patterns and information from server logs to gain insight on user activity including
 - where the users are from,
 - how many clicked
 - what item on the site and
 - the types of activities being done on the site.

2. Web Content Mining

Web content mining

- This is the process of mining useful information from the contents of Web pages and Web documents, which are mostly text, images and audio/video files.
- Techniques used in this discipline have been heavily drawn from natural language processing (NLP) and information retrieval.

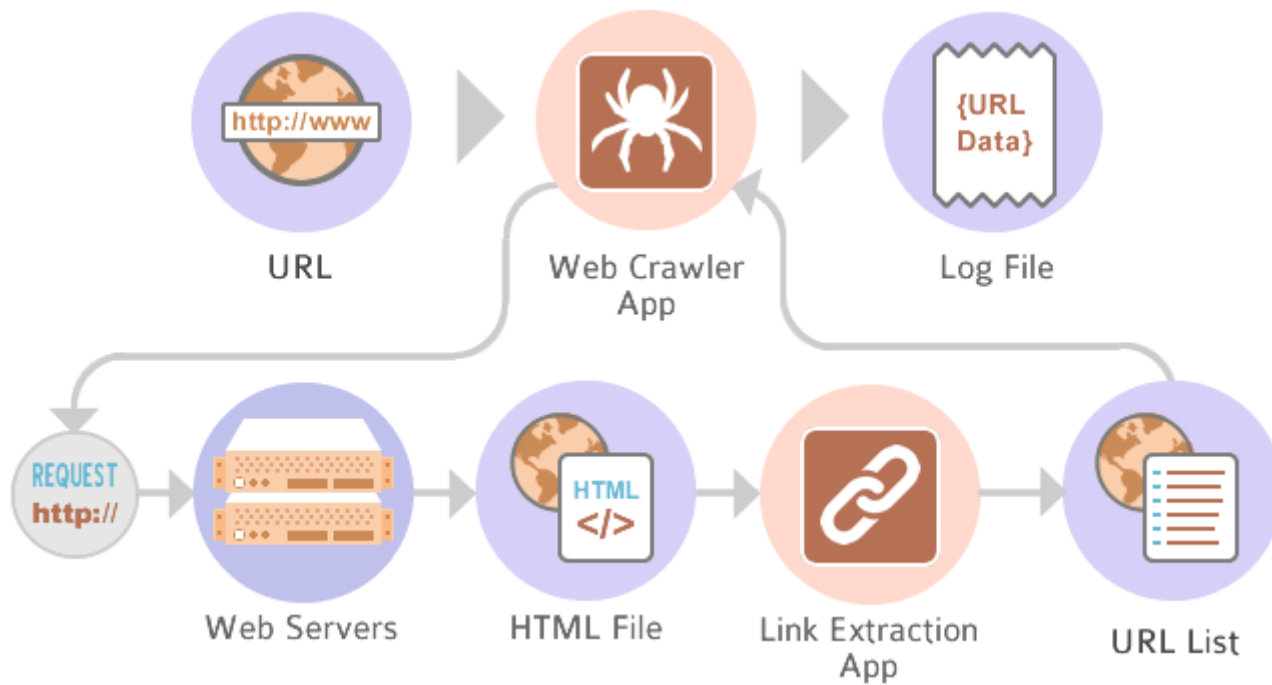
3. Web Structure Mining

Web structure mining

- This is the process of analyzing the nodes and connection structure of a website through the use of graph theory.
- There are two things that can be obtained from this:
 - the structure of a website in terms of how it is connected to other sites and
 - the document structure of the website itself, as to how each page is connected.

Crawling

- Crawling involves acquisition of data about a site.
- It scans the site and gets a complete list of the web page
 - titles,
 - pictures,
 - keywords it contains and
 - links to other pages.
- Now-a-days, crawlers read a copy of the complete page and the additional information like page layout and links on the web page.



Indexing

- Indexing is the process of reading the data from crawler and storing the data in a large database.
- All the data is stored in cast data centers.
- It is designed on factors like merging, storage techniques, index size, lookup speed, maintenance and fault tolerance.

- In layman's terms, Indexing is the **process of adding web pages into Google search**.
- A good idea for **ranking higher in search engines** is to let ***only vital parts*** of your blog/website be indexed.
- ***Do not index unnecessary archives*** like tags, categories, and all other useless pages.

Ranking

- Ranking or retrieval is the process when the user enters a search query and the search engine displays the most relevant pages it finds that matches the query and this is also the most complicated step.
- It is reduced to computation of numeric scores and is based on the factors like relevance feedback and page frequency.

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Lecture -14

1.3.5 Decoding Common Paid Media Platforms

- Paid media refers to external marketing efforts that involve a paid placement.
- Paid media includes PPC(Pay Per Click) advertising, branded content, and display ads.
- Paid media is an essential component of revenue growth and brand awareness for any online businesses.
- One of the most effective solutions is affiliate marketing.

What is PPC?

- PPC is an advertising model where you, as an advertiser, pay a fee each time someone clicks on your online ad.

- It's a way to essentially "buy" visits to your website or landing page.

PPC is most commonly associated with search engine advertising (like Google Ads), but it's also used on social media platforms and other websites. **How PPC Works**

1.Keyword Research: You identify the words and phrases (keywords) that your target audience is likely to use when searching for products or services like yours.

2.Bidding: You bid on those keywords, indicating how much you're willing to pay per click. The more you bid, the more likely your ad is to appear higher in search results or on other platforms.

3.Ad Creation: You create compelling ads that include your keywords and entice users to click.

4.Ad Placement: Search engines and ad platforms display your ads to users when they search for your keywords or when they are on websites relevant to your ads.

5.Click Tracking: Every time someone clicks on your ad, you are charged the amount of your bid (or sometimes less, depending on various factors).

Key Elements of a PPC Campaign

- **Keywords:** The foundation of PPC. Choosing the right keywords is crucial for reaching the right audience.
- **Ad Copy:** Your ad text needs to be engaging and relevant to the keywords you're targeting.
- **Landing Page:** The page users are directed to after clicking your ad. It should be optimized for conversions (e.g., sales, sign-ups).
- **Budget:** How much you're willing to spend on your campaign.
- **Bidding Strategy:** How you choose to bid on keywords (e.g., manual bidding, automated bidding).

Targeting: Options to target your ads based on demographics, location, interests, and more. **Benefits of PPC**

- **Immediate Results:** Unlike organic strategies (like SEO), PPC can drive traffic to your website almost instantly.
- **Targeted Reach:** You can target your ads to specific audiences based on their interests, demographics, and online behavior.
- **Measurable Results:** PPC platforms provide detailed data on your campaign performance, allowing you to track your ROI and make adjustments.
- **Flexibility:** You have control over your budget and can adjust your campaigns as needed.

Common PPC Platforms

- Google Ads:** The most popular PPC platform, allowing you to advertise on Google Search and its partner websites.
- Microsoft Advertising (Bing Ads):** Similar to Google Ads, but for the Bing search engine.
- Social Media Ads:** Platforms like Facebook, Instagram, Twitter, and LinkedIn offer PPC advertising options.

Important Considerations

- Competition:** Popular keywords can be competitive, driving up the cost per click.
- Quality Score:** Search engines like Google consider the relevance and quality of your ads and landing pages, which can affect your ad ranking and cost.
- Ongoing Optimization:** PPC campaigns require regular monitoring and adjustments to maximize their effectiveness.

- Affiliate marketing is known as a marketing technique and practice in which a single business **rewards single or more affiliates for bringing customers or visitors through the principles of affiliate marketing.**
- In other words, as a publisher, you would be rewarded when you **support another business** by promoting their services or products.

Affiliate Marketing techniques

- **Pay per sale:** In this affiliate program, the merchant pays the percentage of the sales price when the purchase is fully done.
- **Pay per lead:** Publisher is paid just once and that too when the referred customers or visitors will provide the target site their contact information by filling the contact form.
- **Pay per click:** This is the most common program in affiliate marketing. With this type of affiliate marketing, publisher will be paid based on the number of visitors you send to the merchant's website.

1.3.6 Black Hat, White Hat and Grey Hat SEO

White Hat SEO

- White hat strategies follow all the rules.
- To properly conduct white hat SEO, businesses need to look at all the latest Google recommendations for proper SEO etiquette and what they like to see in content, and the advice to be followed.
- Today, white hat practices depend primarily on **real human users** to increase page rankings and almost entirely ignore bots.
- If bots or automatic analysis help, that 's all to the good, but white practices **don't** lend itself to dedicated **bot strategies**.
- It's **focus** is primarily on **people**.

- This approach comes with several marketing benefits.
- It tends to favor engagement or discussion, which helps to develop **client relationships** more easily.
- It also helps to get into the habit of **developing stronger content**.

Black Hat SEO

- Black hat strategies are tricks that are **directly banned, discouraged** and punished by search engines.
- They involve plenty of automatic tools and bots that replicate vast amounts of content, as well as paying for **cheap links, keyword stuffing, copying content** to claim as own, hidden text, and other cheap methods.
- These can give a **sharp boost** in rankings, followed quickly by the website getting banned.

- Black hat SEO is which directly flies in the face of Google's stated rules.
- Although Google's current algorithm is considerably more intelligent than previous iterations, **there are still gaps** in the net through which sites using black hat techniques can squeeze.
- Most often, these techniques are limited to small niche sites, but occasionally, **bigger sites are caught** leveraging black hat methods.

Scenario: Imagine you're a local bakery wanting to attract more customers.

White Hat SEO Example:

•Your Approach:

- You create a website with mouth-watering photos of your pastries and detailed descriptions of your ingredients.
- You write blog posts about baking tips, the history of your favorite desserts, and the local farmers you source ingredients from.
- You optimize your website with relevant keywords like "best bakery in [your town]," "fresh croissants," and "custom cakes."
- You build relationships with local food bloggers and get featured in their articles.
- You ensure your website is mobile-friendly and loads quickly.

Outcome:

Over time, your website ranks higher in search results for relevant keywords. Local customers find your bakery online and are drawn in by your delicious content and positive reviews. You establish your bakery as a trusted and reputable business in the community.

Black Hat SEO Example: Your Approach: You stuff your website with keywords like "cheap cakes," "discount pastries," and "free cookies" even if they don't accurately reflect your offerings. You buy hundreds of backlinks from spammy websites to artificially inflate your website's popularity. You copy content from other bakeries' websites and pass it off as your own. You create fake online reviews to boost your bakery's reputation.

Outcome: Initially, you might see a temporary boost in your website's ranking. However, search engines quickly detect your manipulative tactics and penalize your website. Your website's ranking plummets, and you might even get completely removed from search results. Your bakery's reputation is damaged, and customers lose trust in your business.

Key Takeaway:

White hat SEO is about building a strong online presence through honest and ethical practices. It's a long-term strategy that requires effort and patience, but it yields sustainable results and builds trust with your audience. Black hat SEO, on the other hand, is a risky gamble that can lead to severe consequences for your business.

Grey Hat SEO

- Grey hat refers to many techniques which resides in the grey area of Google's Webmaster Guidelines.
- Often, although not specifically prohibited, they also don't exactly follow the spirit of the white hat advice given elsewhere and may be techniques that Google could crack down in the future.
- Grey hat strategies avoid anything that's explicitly banned or discouraged, but step freely everywhere else.

- Here the technical details are still important, and marketers are willing to use bots and other automatic forms of analysis to give their page rankings a bump.
- Grey hat is an **effective way** to give the content **a starting boost**, especially while developing a new website.
- A good example is, using link distribution tools to automatically spread the content to applicable platforms.
- The problem with a grey hat approach is that it **focuses on poorly defined SEO techniques**.

- In other words, many of these grey tactics have been ignored by search engines or not actually allowed.
- Grey hat practices are always moving toward either white hat status, or black hat bans, and the bans tend to be more common.
- This means that if companies use any grey hat methods, they must keep up with any official or apparent changes to SEO algorithms.
- **For example, “article spinning” or writing a new article that plagiarize the content of a similar article (found somewhere online) is currently grey hat,**
- **But Google may create more stringent analysis in the future that marks you down for articles that look too much like copies, even if your wording is different.**

Common Grey Hat Techniques (with examples):

Paid Reviews (without proper disclosure): Purchasing positive reviews for your business or product without clearly disclosing the paid nature of the review.

Risk: If discovered, this can damage trust and lead to penalties.

Reciprocal Link Exchanges: Agreeing to link to another website if they link back to you, often regardless of the quality or relevance of the sites.

Risk: Search engines prioritize natural link building. Excessive or manipulative link exchanges can be seen as unnatural.

Exact Match Domains (with low-quality content): Purchasing domain names that exactly match target keywords, but filling the site with thin or irrelevant content.

Risk: While exact match domains aren't inherently bad, they can raise red flags if the site lacks valuable content.

The Risks of Grey Hat SEO Penalties: If search engines detect grey hat tactics, they may penalize your website, leading to lower rankings or even removal from search results.

Reputational Damage: Engaging in questionable practices can damage your brand reputation and erode trust with your audience.

Algorithm Updates: Search engines regularly update their algorithms, and what works today may not work tomorrow. Grey hat tactics are particularly vulnerable to these updates.

Wasted Resources: Investing time and money in grey hat techniques can be a waste if they stop working or lead to penalties

Feature	White Hat SEO	Grey Hat SEO	Black Hat SEO
Ethics	Ethical and compliant with guidelines	Unethical and violates guidelines	Unethical and violates guidelines
Focus	User experience and long-term value	Manipulating search engines for quick wins	Manipulating search engines for quick wins
Techniques	High-quality content, technical optimization, genuine link building	Paid reviews, link exchanges, article spinning, domain authority manipulation	Keyword stuffing, cloaking, link schemes, duplicate content
Results	Sustainable and long-term	Short-term and risky	Short-term and risky
Risks	Minimal risk	Moderate risk	High risk of penalties and damage to reputation